

The Collection of Purposeful Utterances

Udānavarga · Toh 326 · Derge Kangyur

ཆདེ་དྲུར་ཐོག་པའི་ཆོས་སྒྲུབ་

Toh 326 in the Kangyur is a canonical Buddhist scripture known in Sanskrit as the Udānavarga and in Tibetan as the Cheddu Jöpe Tsom, meaning The Collection of Purposeful Utterances. It is a collection of inspired or solemn verses attributed to the Buddha, organized into topical chapters, and represents an expanded Indic compilation related to the Pali Udāna and Dhammapada traditions, gathering pithy sayings and verse teachings spoken by the Buddha on various occasions. The text opens with homage to the Omniscient One and moves swiftly into verses on impermanence, the urgency of spiritual practice, and the nature of suffering, setting a tone of earnest moral and contemplative instruction aimed at motivating practitioners. As a verse anthology of the Buddha's direct speech, it belongs to the broader class of sūtra literature within the Kangyur.

In the language of India: Udānavarga. In the language of Tibet: The Collection of Purposeful Utterances. The First Fascicle.

Homage to the Omniscient One. May all be auspicious.

The purposeful utterances spoken by the Victor
I shall now set forth with care.

Dispel your drowsiness and dullness,
gladden your mind, and listen well.

The Omniscient One, the Protector,
the Sage who cared for beings with compassion,
holding his last bodily existence,
the Blessed One spoke these words:

Alas — all formations are impermanent,
they have the nature of arising and perishing.
Having arisen, they fall into ruin;
their stilling is bliss.

When everything is ablaze,
what cause is there for laughter, what for song?
You who dwell enshrouded in darkness —
why do you not seek a lamp?

These things that are cast away,
white as bleached bone,
scattered in every direction —
seeing this, what is there to rejoice in?

The person who enters the womb
in the course of a single night
will not remain but must pass on,
and once gone, does not return.

In the morning one may see many people;
by evening some will be seen no more.
In the evening one may see many people;
by morning some will be seen no more.

Men, women in great number,
even those in the prime of life will die —
who, then, would say of any person, "this one is young,"
and take pride in the warmth of being alive?

Some will die within the womb,
some likewise on the ground where they are born,
some when they have just learned to crawl,
some when they can run about.
Some are old, some young,
some are people in the prime of life —
one by one they pass away
like ripe fruit falling.

Just as ripened fruit
ever lives in fear of falling,
so too a person who has been born
forever lives in fear of death.

Just as a potter who fashions vessels
from clay —
every single one ends in ruin at last —
so too is the life of human beings.

Just as a loom being stretched,
as thread after thread is drawn through,
each thread pressing against the one behind,

so too is the life of human beings.

Just as those who are condemned to death,
with every step they take,
draw ever closer to the place of execution,
so too is the life of human beings.

Just as the current of a swift flowing river
never turns back,
so the passing of a human life
can never be reversed.

Difficult, brief,
and saturated with suffering —
it perishes swiftly,
like a line drawn on water.

Just as a herdsman bearing a staff
drives the cattle home to their place,
so illness and old age
drive human beings into the presence of the lord of death.

Like the water of a waterfall,
as days and nights flow past,
the life of human beings is exhausted,
and vitality draws close to ruin.

A firefly makes the night seem long;
a road makes smoke-signals seem far.
For the childish who do not know the true Dharma,
saṃsāra is long.

"I have a son; likewise I have wealth" —
by such thoughts the fool is ruined.
When there is no self, within or without,
whose child is it, and what, indeed, is wealth?

Clans of men and women,
hundreds and thousands and many more,
even those who have properly secured their prosperity —
all will fall into the power of the lord of death.

Everything accumulated is finally exhausted;
what is raised up will finally topple.
What has met will finally part;
the end of living is death.

Since the end of life is death,
all sentient beings will die,
and following their virtue and their evil
toward their respective fruits,
they go in accordance with their karma exactly as it is:
through evil deeds, to hell;
through merit, to the happy destinies;
and others, by cultivating the path,
will attain undefiled nirvāṇa.

Whether buddhas, pratyekabuddhas,
or even the śrāvakas of the buddhas —
if they too relinquish this bodily form,
what need is there to speak of ordinary people?

There is no place anywhere to dwell
that is beyond the reach of death:
not in the sky above, not in the midst of the ocean,
not even by entering into the heart of the mountains.

All that has come to be and all that will come to be —
every one of them departs, leaving this body behind.
Let the wise understand that all of this is subject to destruction,
and abide in the Dharma, living the holy life (brahmacarya).

Seeing old age, seeing the suffering of sickness,
and seeing death that severs one from mind and breath,
with resolution one should abandon the household, which is like a prison,
though for ordinary worldly people the renunciation of desire is rare.

Even the king's chariot, so brilliantly adorned, will perish.
In just the same way, this body too draws ever nearer to decay.
But this Dharma of the noble ones is itself noble:
the supreme among human beings realizes it, and it does not grow old.

Old age, you are foolish and ungainly.
You are one who acts without propriety.

Even this pleasing form
has been utterly crushed by you.

One who lives for a full hundred years
is still carried away by death itself.
All these beings age,
fall ill, and are vanquished by death.

They go on, never turning back,
disintegrating utterly through day and night,
endowed with the suffering of birth and death —
like fish being boiled in a pot of hot water.

This life, by day and by night,
whether going or staying,
passes like the current of a great river,
never to return.

Like a fish in a shallow stream —
one for whom each passing day and night
makes this life grow ever shorter —
what reason is there to rejoice?

Because the end of living is death,
this body ages completely,
this nest of disease swiftly falls apart,
and even this mass of flesh will perish.

Alas, this body, without support,
empty and severed from consciousness,
will topple to the ground
like a discarded log thrown in a charnel ground.

Constantly tormented by illness,
always leaking impurity,
worn down and diminished by old age and death —
why would one not wish to abandon this body?

With this body so swiftly crumbling, full of pus and disease,
and with no certainty whatsoever of accomplishment or happiness,
strive instead for the sake of the supreme peace.

Thinking, "I shall do this in winter, in spring, in summer" —
so the childish one deliberates,
and the obstacles are not seen.

The mind of a person is attached
to children, wealth, and livestock.
The lord of death takes him and goes,
as a flood sweeps away a sleeping village.

When the time of death has come,
one's children will not be a refuge,
nor one's father, nor one's relatives —
there is none who can become your refuge.

"This task is already done; now I will do that.
Having done those things, I shall then do this" —
while a person thus deliberates on and on,
old age and illness strike, and death overwhelms him directly.

Therefore, always take delight in meditative absorption and rest in equipoise.
Generate diligence; do not wait for the end of birth and old age.
Overwhelm Māra and all his hosts completely.
Monks, strive to go beyond the far shore of birth and death.

This concludes the first chapter, on impermanence.

Desire arises from conceptual thought (vikalpa),
so know this to be the very root of desire.
Do not engage in conceptual thought,
and thereby desire will not arise in you.

From desires, sorrow is born;
from desires, fear arises.
For one who is entirely free of desires,
there is no sorrow and no fear.

From joys, sorrow is born;
from joys, fear arises.
For one who is entirely free of joys,
there is no sorrow and no fear.

The ripening of sensual pleasures is suffering:
sweet at first, yet the fruit is bitter.
Like a child who will not let go of a burning torch,

in the end it burns the one who holds it.

Look at those who cling with utter attachment
to children and daughters, to jeweled earrings —
the noble ones declare that the bonds made of iron
and of rope and wood are not the tightest bonds of all.

The noble ones declare that the bond of desire,
however slack it may appear, is hard to fully loosen.
Those who are steadfast, not looking to the pleasures of desire,
sever these bonds and swiftly move onward.

The many-formed things of the world are not the desire;
it is the person's conceptual thought and attachment that is desire.
The many-formed things of the world remain just as they are,
yet those who are steadfast subdue their longing toward them.

People possess no lasting pleasure,
for whatever desired thing they are attached to is impermanent.
Therefore, since there is no further existence to be had,
relinquish it thoroughly in your mind,
and it is taught: know how to make of death a place that does not change.

Is it not so that longing arises and then exhausts itself?
That which is blameless in mind, together with mindfulness,
and non-attachment, each in its own way, to desires —
that, it is taught, is what moves one higher.

Just as a smith refines silver,
so one who possesses wisdom, gradually,
moment by moment, little by little,
should remove one's own impurities.

Just as a cobbler thoroughly softens leather
and then fashions shoes from it,
so each and every desire that is abandoned
yields a happiness that is complete and excellent.

If you wish for happiness in its entirety,
abandon all desires entirely.
By abandoning all desires completely,
you will attain the highest happiness.

For as long as one follows after desire,
for that long one will never be satisfied.
Those who turn away from it by means of wisdom —
they attain contentment.

Since one cannot find satisfaction through desires,
find satisfaction happily through wisdom.
A person who is satisfied through wisdom
will not fall under the power of existence.

Those men who are attached to desires —
alas, they delight in what is contrary to Dharma.
While they dwell in the briefest flash of life,
they will not come to see the obstacles before them.

Those of poor understanding, overcome by wealth,
do not seek the farther shore;
with minds scattered and clinging to desire through craving,
they bring ruin to themselves and to others as well.

Even were a rain of gold coins to fall,
those bound by desires would never be satisfied.
The wise have understood within themselves
that desires bring small pleasure and many faults.

Even toward the pleasures of the gods
one should feel no special delight.
Fully awakened buddhas and śrāvakas
rejoice through the exhaustion of craving.

Even if there were a mountain of gold
equal in size to the Himālayas,
know that not even one person would be satisfied by such wealth —
understand this and conduct yourself well.

Those who know the cause of suffering
will never delight in desire.
Knowing desire to be the cause of pain in the world,
they study the teaching in order to tame it.

This concludes the second chapter, on desires.

Embodied beings, utterly overwhelmed by conceptual thought,
looking to impurity as clean and pure out of unbearable desire —

desire increases and spreads still further,
and by that very bond it draws itself tighter.

Those who delight in the quieting of conceptual thought
and who continuously cultivate mindfulness of the unattractive —
by thoroughly abandoning craving in regard to that,
they cause those bonds of theirs to decay and crumble.

Shrouded in the darkness that is desire,
covered by the canopy of craving,
bound by the bonds of heedlessness,
they are like fish that have fallen into the net of the fisherman.

A person who lives in utter heedlessness —
craving grows in that one like a climbing vine;
one drifts after aging and death,
like a calf that desires its mother's milk.

Those who produce recollection, who produce attachment,
who entertain thoughts toward what is mentally pleasant —
through these they wander again and again in cyclic existence,
like a monkey in a forest who desires its fruit.

A person who constantly pursues pleasure
draws ever nearer to birth and aging.

Those driven by the craving of sentient beings push one forward —
like a rabbit that races in circles through a snare.

Sentient beings bound by craving,
their minds attached to existence and non-existence alike,
those childish ones who delight in the junctions and pleasures of clinging —
they meet with suffering again and again.

People are separated from success and happiness;
possessed of the bonds of Māra,
they follow after aging and death —
like a calf that desires its mother's milk.

But the one here who abandons craving such as this,
free from craving for existence and non-existence,
that monk who overcomes existence —
passes fully into nirvāṇa, without remainder.

The one who is driven by craving's woman,
that craving so hard to abandon in the world —
that one's sorrow will grow and grow,
like grass upon which rain has fallen.

The one who abandons craving's woman,
that craving so hard to abandon in the world —
that one's sorrow will be turned back,
like water drops from a lotus.

Therefore, to all of you who have assembled here,
I speak for your well-being:
as usira grass is pulled out by its roots,
so too pull out craving, root and all.

When a person keeps company with craving,
one wanders for a very long time.
So pull craving out by the root —
then there is no sorrow and no fear.

Taking up and grasping again and again,
entering the womb again and again,
through transitions and transformations,
sentient beings go and come.

Therefore abandon that craving so hard to abandon here,
cut the seed —
then in that one craving will not arise,
and that one will not circle in saṃsāra again.

Without squandering the leisure and endowment one has obtained,
strive against the craving for objects
that binds one and sets one among gods and humans with worldly aims.
Even if a sentient being is born in hell,
one who has squandered leisure and endowment will come to regret it.

Because craving for objects, the basis of results,
is the cause of wandering the ocean of existence,
covering one with a net of creepers and ensnaring,
burning and unsubdued —
this suffering will not be reversed in any respect, again and again.

For example, if a tree is not uprooted,
even though cut down it simply grows back again.
Likewise, if the subtle tendril of craving is not pulled out,
this suffering will not be reversed again and again.

For example, just as a weapon fashioned by oneself
slays the maker by a thief's power,
so too craving, arising from within one's own mind,
slays the one who has a body.

Knowing in this way the faults by which
suffering arises from craving,
the monk who is endowed with mindfulness
should abandon craving, eliminate grasping,
and travel through everything.

This is the third chapter, on craving.

Heedfulness is the ground of the deathless.
Heedlessness is the ground of death.
The heedful do not die.
Those who are heedless are as if always dead.

Knowing well this distinction,
the wise are endowed with heedfulness.
Those who rejoice greatly in heedfulness —
they rejoice in the domain of noble ones.

The one who continuously cultivates heedfulness,
steadfast and ever conquering the other shore —
through that steadfastness one attains the unsurpassed ease of completion
and touches nirvāṇa.

When the wise one, through heedfulness,
has overcome heedlessness —
ascending the palace of wisdom,
sorrowless, one looks down upon
those in sorrow, the steadfast upon mountain peaks
looking down upon those who are children on the ground.

Through diligence, heedfulness,
perfect restraint and discipline,
the wise one, having made an island,

turns back the great flood.

The one who is diligent and endowed with mindfulness,
who acts with purity and with careful examination,
who lives by right restraint and by the Dharma —
the renown of such heedful ones openly increases.

Be heedful with respect to higher mind,
and train in the rules of restraint laid down by the Sage.
One who guards with mindfulness, abiding in constant peace —
that guarding is nirvāṇa.

Do not rely on lowly dharmas,
do not resort to heedlessness.
Do not incline toward wrong views,
and do not let the world proliferate.

Whoever possesses, in the highest degree,
the right view that is worldly —
even across a thousand lifetimes
that one will not go to lower destinies.

One who gives himself over to heedlessness
is a foolish person whose thinking goes to ruin.
As a merchant guards his wealth,
so let the wise one be endowed with heedfulness.

Not giving oneself over to heedlessness,
not pursuing delight in desires,
and ever holding the mind in heedfulness —
such a one will attain the exhaustion of defilements.

Even if the exhaustion of defilements has not yet been attained,
do not at this time indulge in heedlessness.
Like a lion, not a deer of the wilds,
the heedless ones will be slain.

The man who, driven by heedlessness, resorts to another's wife —
four circumstances arise to settle in his mind:
he fails to gain merit, he does not sleep at ease;
third, he is reviled; and fourth, he falls into hell.

He who gains no merit goes the way of evil destinies,
and with fear and shame beside him, his happiness is small.
He is cut down by the king's severe punishment,
and this body is scorched in the hell-realms.

Therefore, whoever desires to see their own good
should act in accordance with what was said above.
Do not let diligence become weak with constancy,
for it goes the way of a child's cart.

For example, just as children's carts
abandon the great good road
and go along bad roads,
bringing ruin like an eye that is broken —
so likewise those who abandon the Dharma
and follow what is not the Dharma,
those foolish ones go under the power of the lord of death
and, like the broken eye, meet with destruction.

Those who abandon what should be done
and do what should not be done,
and who conduct themselves with arrogant heedlessness —
for all such ones, the defilements multiply.
And for those whose defilements multiply,
the undefiled is far, far away.

Those whose mindfulness is constantly applied to the body,
who steadily apply themselves to what is good,
who do not do what should not be done
and continually do what should be done,
and who are endowed with mindfulness and vigilance —
for them, the defilements will be exhausted.
And for those whose defilements are exhausted,
they will attain the undefiled.

However much one may speak,
if one does not hold to the true Dharma,
those who here have heard but little
yet who have realized the teachings through their body —
those who are heedful in the Dharma,
they are the ones who hold the true Dharma.

Even if one speaks at length with reasoned argument,
heedless persons will not act accordingly.
Just as a cowherd counts the cattle of another,
they have not obtained the share of the ascetic life.

But even if one speaks only a little with reasoned argument,
yet walks in the Dharma in accordance with the Dharma,
and abandons attachment, aversion, and delusion —
such ones have obtained the share of the ascetic life.

He who proclaims the praise of heedfulness
and ever reproaches heedlessness —
heedfulness, which was praised even by a hundredfold sacrifice,
has become foremost among the gods.

Whether a deed is done or left undone,
the wise one proclaims the praise of heedfulness.
The wise one who is equipped with heedfulness
takes up both benefits fully:
what the benefit of this life is,
and what the benefit of the next life is —
by grasping these steadily and with discernment,
one is accordingly called wise.

The monk who delights in heedfulness
and looks upon heedlessness with fear
pulls himself free from lower destinies,
like a great elephant from a swamp.

The monk who delights in heedfulness
and looks upon heedlessness with fear
shakes off unwholesome dharmas
like the wind shakes the leaves of a tree.

The monk who delights in heedfulness
and looks upon heedlessness with fear
causes all bonds, subtle and coarse,
to be consumed as if by fire.

The monk who delights in heedfulness
and looks upon heedlessness with fear
gradually, through cultivation,

exhausts every one of his bonds.

The monk who delights in heedfulness
and looks upon heedlessness with fear
individually realizes the peaceful stage
of the stilling and cessation of formations.

The monk who delights in heedfulness
and looks upon heedlessness with fear —
and looks upon heedlessness with fear —
because of his nearness to nirvāṇa,
he cannot fall away at all.

The monk who is endowed with diligence, possessed of heedfulness,
and who practices the Dharma and practices it well
will attain happiness in this world and the next
through his practice of the Dharma.

For the sake of peace, take refuge in the training;
arouse effort and generate diligence.
Lack of mindfulness, heedlessness,
little diligence, absence of restraint,
drowsiness, torpor, and distraction —
these are obstacles to the training.
Therefore, having understood that limb,
do not let mindfulness be squandered and wasted.

The monk who is good in moral discipline
and who delights in heedfulness —
let him set all conceptual thought at rest
and guard his own mind accordingly.
He should rouse himself and lift himself up,
and enter into the teaching of the Buddha.
Like a great elephant against a house of clay,
let him crush the army of the Lord of Death.

Whoever practices with heedfulness
in this very Dharma of discipline,
having fully abandoned the wandering of birth,
will make an end of suffering.

This is the fourth chapter: on the island of heedfulness.

Grief arises from those one holds dear;
fear arises from those one holds dear.
When one is fully free from those held dear,
there is no grief, and there is no fear.

From those one loves, grief arises;
from love comes suffering; from love comes fear.
When those one loves are transformed by change,
one is stricken with bewilderment and distress.

However many forms of suffering in the world,
however many laments and cries of sorrow —
all of these arise in dependence on those held dear.
When attachment to the dear is abandoned, they cease to exist.

For those who have nothing dear anywhere in the world
are those who dwell in happiness and are free from grief.
Therefore one who seeks to be without anguish and without stain
should never make anything a beloved object.

From not seeing those held dear comes suffering;
and from seeing those not dear it is the same.
Therefore never meet with what is dear,
and never meet with what is not dear.

From separation from what is dear
and from encounter with what is not dear,
the unbearable grief arises
that makes impure beings grow old.

When one who is dear has died,
many relatives and close friends
grieve for a long time
and suffer through separation from the beloved.

One in whom there is neither the dear nor the not-dear
has no binding knot.
Therefore do not make an evil one
into a beloved.

Looking only at the beloved and abandoning one's purpose,
not engaging in the things that lead to happiness,

while those who are themselves bound to unhappiness
yearn after the things of happiness —

Those who are fettered by the pleasure of beautiful form,
across the various classes of gods and humans,
commit evil and fall to ruin,
and come under the power of aging and death.

But whoever, through day and through night,
practices heedfulness and abandons beautiful form,
uproots from the very base
the food of Māra that is so hard to abandon, and the root of evil.

Through appearing as what is good when it is not good,
through appearing as what is dear when it is not dear,
and through appearing as happiness when it is suffering,
the heedless are utterly overcome.

If one wishes to do good to oneself,
since happiness cannot be obtained with ease
through the one who acts harmfully,
one should not lead this self into what is beloved.

If one wishes to do good to oneself,
since happiness will be obtained with ease
through the one who acts rightly,
one should not lead this self into evil.

Just as the cities of the wilderness
are surrounded by firm ramparts —
if one wishes to do good to oneself,
guard this self, and guard it well.

If one wishes to do good to oneself,
then in whichever of the three periods it may be,
with the skill of one who fans a flame,
hide this self, and hide it well.

Just as the cities of the wilderness
are guarded within and without by sentinels —
so that the endowment of leisure and opportunity is not wasted and
consumed,

in just that way should the self be guarded.

Were one to be born in the hells,
one would come to regret the wasting of leisure and opportunity.

Though with the mind one searches in every direction,
one finds no one anywhere more dear than oneself.

In just the same way, each being holds itself most dear.
Therefore one who is self-cherishing should not harm others.
Life is dear to all beings,
and all tremble before the fear of being cut off.
Measuring by one's own experience,
one should neither beat nor kill.

A man who has been exiled to a distant land,
when he returns after a long time without news from home,
is greeted by his kinsmen, friends, and loved ones
and met with joyful cries of delight.

In the same way, a person who has done merit,
when he has passed from this world to the beyond,
is met by his merits, bright as the light of day,
and is filled with manifest joy.

Therefore, for the sake of the world beyond,
accumulate merit.

Merit becomes the support and dwelling place
of those who bear a body in the next world.

One who does what is good and noble in conduct —
the gods praise their virtue.
Even here they will not be despised,
and in the higher realms they will find joy.

Abiding in the Dharma, perfect in moral discipline,
knowing shame, and speaking truth —
in doing their own proper work,
they bring joy to all other people.
In pursuing their own good thus,
others too become glad,
and in the Dharma that is visible they are praised,

and in the beyond they go to a happy destiny.

When counseled, they speak words of assent,
and in turning others away from improper conduct,
the noble ones rejoice.

Those who are not noble will not rejoice.

Therefore, between the noble and the ignoble,
when the separation of death has come,
the ignoble go to hell,
while the noble go to the higher realms.

This is the fifth chapter, on what is dear.

Those who seek the threefold good —
to be praised, to obtain wealth,
and to find joy in a happy destiny beyond —
let the wise guard moral discipline.

To be noble, to have the fullness of vision,
to become a support for the peace of the world —
seeing these further states,
let the wise guard moral discipline.

Through moral discipline, one attains happiness,
free of all torment in the body.
At night one sleeps in peace,
and upon waking one finds joy as well.

Through the merit made by the wise
in generosity and moral discipline,
both in this life and in the next
one comes always to happiness.

Virtuous in moral discipline until old age,
well established in faith — this is excellent.
Wisdom is the precious jewel of the human being,
and it is difficult for even the destitute in merit to destroy.

A monk, abiding in moral discipline,
restraining the sense faculties,
knowing the measure in food,
and striving in non-sleep —

dwelling thus with diligence,
not given to torpor by day or night —
because of closeness to nirvāṇa,
decline and deterioration cannot occur.

A person, established in moral discipline,
diligently training in the cultivation of mind and wisdom,
the monk who abides with certainty
will attain the exhaustion of suffering.

Therefore always guard moral discipline,
follow and protect meditative absorption,
train in insight,
and be mindful and vigilant, each in its own way.

By that, having exhausted all binding connections,
one becomes free of mind, leaving nothing behind.
The one possessed of wisdom who has shed the body
attains the immeasurable nirvāṇa.

One who has trained well in these three —
moral discipline, meditative absorption, and wisdom —
having reached the utter end, perfectly stainless,
free of torment, with becoming exhausted,
fully released from the bonds of attachment,
having shed the body, yet possessed of wisdom,
having gone beyond the domain of Māra,
blazes forth like the sun upon the path.

A monk who is careless and arrogant
with regard to outer and inner conduct —
his moral discipline, meditative absorption, and wisdom
will not be brought to perfect completion.

From cloud-cover rain falls,
while from a clear sky rain does not fall.
Therefore dispel the obscuring cover,
and in this way the rain will indeed fall.

Thus it is that the monk who always sees clearly
and is restrained by the vow of moral discipline —
is purified swiftly on the path leading to nirvāṇa.

The fragrance of flowers does not travel against the wind,
nor does sandal, nor costus, nor jasmine.
But the fragrance of the noble ones travels against the wind —
the fragrance of the excellent person pervades every direction.

Among all these kinds of fragrance —
costus, sandalwood,
blue lotus, and jasmine —
the fragrance of moral discipline is supreme.

The fragrance of costus and sandalwood,
however it may be, is slight.
But the fragrance of one endowed with moral discipline
pervades this world and the heavens alike.

Therefore dwell in heedfulness
and purify your moral discipline completely.
When one is liberated through perfect understanding,
the path of Māra will not be found.

This is the path to happiness,
and on this path of purification,
having entered and trained with diligence,
abandon the bonds of Māra.

This is the sixth chapter on moral discipline.

Having abandoned the wrong conduct of body
and practised the right conduct of body,
if one guards against the great wrongs of body,
one will have achieved restraint of body.

Having abandoned the wrong conduct of speech
and practised the right conduct of speech,
if one guards against the great wrongs of speech,
one will have achieved restraint of speech.

Having abandoned the wrong conduct of mind
and practised the right conduct of mind,
if one guards against the great wrongs of mind,
one will have achieved restraint of mind.

Abandon wrong conduct of body,
abandon wrong conduct of speech,
abandon wrong conduct of mind,
and abandon whatever other faults one may have.

Perform the virtuous acts of body,
perform the many virtuous acts of speech,
perform the virtuous acts of mind,
and be endowed with the four immeasurables.

When one performs the virtuous acts of body
and acts likewise in speech and mind,
in this life and in the next as well
one will always attain happiness.

Because body is always restrained,
the Sage is one who does no harm.
He goes toward the abode of the deathless,
and wherever he goes there is no sorrow.

Because speech is always restrained,
the Sage is one who does no harm.
He goes toward the abode of the deathless,
and wherever he goes there is no sorrow.

Because mind is always restrained,
the Sage is one who does no harm.
He goes toward the abode of the deathless,
and wherever he goes there is no sorrow.

Those who are steadfast restrain the body,
those who are steadfast restrain speech as well,
those who are steadfast restrain the mind —
if by steadfastness all is restrained,
they go toward the abode of the deathless,
and wherever they go there is no sorrow.

Restraint of body is excellent.
Restraint of speech is excellent.
Restraint of mind is also excellent.
To be restrained in every respect is excellent.
The monk who is restrained in all things

is fully liberated from all suffering.

Guard your speech, restrain your mind well,
and let the body commit no non-virtue.
If these three pathways of action are fully purified,
you will attain the path proclaimed by the sages.

This is the seventh chapter on right conduct.

Those who, having done something, say they have not done it,
and those who speak falsehood — they will go to hell.
Both of these, being alike, pass to the beyond
and come to possess the qualities of the low.

In the mouth of the person who is born
and who speaks harsh and wicked words,
an axe of speech arises with which
one cuts oneself down.

One who praises those who deserve blame
and blames those who deserve praise —
such a person gathers all manner of quarrels through the mouth,
and the quarrelsome one will not attain happiness.

The loss one sustains through dice,
along with all one's wealth — that quarrel amounts to very little.
But one who stirs up the mind against the Sugata (the Well-Gone One, the
Buddha) —

that quarrel here is exceedingly great. If one relies upon the sin of reviling the
noble ones through word and thought, one goes to the hells where bubbles
burst — a hundred thousand and forty-one thousand bubbles in number, as
sentient beings.

Speaking faults against the innocent with a sinful mind amounts to nothing but
multiplying one's own hell for one's own destruction. The powerful and
blameless endure with patience and do not disturb their minds on account of
such people.

One who, out of ruinous thinking, relies upon a sinful view, and thereby causes
noble ones, arhats, and those who live by the Dharma to abandon the teaching
— such a one is like a bamboo plant: it is slain by its own fruit.

One should speak only pleasant words; one should not speak wicked words. When scorching speech befalls the wicked, it is right that one should speak pleasant words instead. When a foolish wicked person speaks, they become bound by what they say; and if, in speaking, they drive others away, the noble ones do not say such things.

The monk who restrains his speech, who speaks gently and without arrogance, who sets forth meaning in accordance with the Dharma — that one is said to speak pleasantly. "Speaking well is supreme," declare the noble ones. That is the first. Speaking pleasantly and not unpleasantly is the second. Speaking truth and not falsehood is the third. Speaking Dharma and not ordinary talk is the fourth.

One should speak such words — words by which one does not torment oneself and by which one does no harm to others. Those words one should speak well. One should speak only pleasant words — words that cause genuine delight, words that do not give rise to sin, words that gladden others when spoken.

The word of truth is nectar; the word of truth is unsurpassed. The holy ones teach that truth, established in meaning and in Dharma, is truth indeed. The words the Buddha spoke in order to abandon all suffering — words of truth leading to nirvāṇa — those are unsurpassed.

This is the eighth canto: The Collection on Speech.

Surpassing all other things, having destroyed the world beyond, there is nothing whatsoever of sin that a person possessed of a body who speaks falsehood will not do. Those who have eaten glowing iron balls aflame with tongues of fire — that is far easier to bear than that one who is lax in conduct and not well restrained should eat the alms-food of the realm.

You who fear suffering, you for whom suffering is unwelcome — whether in the open or in secret, do not perform sinful actions. If you have performed a sinful action, or are even in the midst of performing one, there is no escape from suffering even if you rise up crying "I flee!" and run away.

There is no place anywhere where one can stand beyond the reach of karma: not in the sky, not in the midst of the ocean, not by entering into the clefts of mountains. Having examined what those on the other side have done — seeing sinful actions — one should say: "I will not do these." For karma follows upon sin committed.

Actions that are utterly unbearable — cheating with false weights and measures, harming people, inducing others to act wrongly — the aftermath of such actions follows a person, and by them one falls into the abyss.

Whatever virtuous or sinful actions a person has performed, those actions do not perish: they ripen as results in just that way. As long as their accumulation remains, so long do they strike. Others then strike in return, and the one who strikes is examined. The childish one who has not reflected — thinking "this will not follow me" — through sinful actions, beings come to know the beyond.

If one who is childish commits sinful actions out of ignorance, then at some point those very actions ripen as burning results, one by one: tormented by their own karma under that weight, scorched as if by fire.

The childish ones of meager wisdom, by acting toward themselves as enemies, are performing actions whose fruit will grow great —

performing sinful actions — and those very deeds, once done, torment one as one weeps, face hidden in tears. The karmic maturation that follows each of these deeds, ripening one by one: it is better not to have done such things. But whatever action, once done, causes no torment, and is met with joy and a happy mind — the karmic maturation that follows each of these deeds, ripening one by one: it is better to have done such things.

One who, out of desire for one's own happiness, performs sinful deeds with reckless abandon will weep as the maturation of those sinful deeds is experienced. Sinful actions do not immediately become certain, as though they were milk. Yet as fire is covered by ash, they burn the childish one. Sinful actions do not cut with the immediacy of a sword, yet the destinies shaped by sinful karma become fully manifest in the beyond. For wherever the hot, individually ripening maturation of those deeds takes effect, the destinies shaped by sinful karma will be known in the beyond.

Rust rises from iron, and having arisen, it eats away at the very iron itself. Likewise, one who acts without reflection goes to the lower realms by one's own karma.

This is the ninth chapter, on karma.

Faith and a sense of shame, moral discipline, and generosity — these qualities are praised by noble persons. By these one goes to the world of the gods, and it is said that through this very path one arrives in the realm of the gods. Those who are cowardly do not go to the world of the gods, and so the childish

one does not proclaim the praise of generosity. The steadfast rejoice in giving, and thereby they experience happiness elsewhere.

Here, the supreme wealth of a person is faith; here, through the Dharma and good conduct, one attains happiness. Truth alone is the finest taste among tastes; living by wisdom, it is said, is the highest form of life.

Generating faith in the Dharma of the arhats, who go to nirvāṇa — if one listens to them with respectful attentiveness and wisdom, one thereby attains wisdom of each kind. Through vigilance one is delivered from the ocean, and through faith from rivers; through diligence one abandons suffering; and through wisdom one becomes wholly right.

A monk endowed with faith as a companion, led on by wisdom, and filled with delight in nirvāṇa, will cut through every bond. One who has cultivated faith, moral discipline, and wisdom well — that wise person, abandoning faults, is said to be possessed of noble conduct.

One who is endowed with faith and moral discipline in full measure, who is generous, who has cast out timidity — wherever such a person goes, they will be revered in that very place. Among those who live wisely in the world, cultivating faith and wisdom, these are their supreme wealth; other ordinary wealth simply wastes away.

One who aspires to see noble ones, who delights in hearing the true Dharma, who has fully abandoned the stain of miserliness — that one is called a person of faith. Send provisions along the path of faith; merit in abundance cannot be stolen by anyone. Thieves who come to plunder are stopped. Let those who have the Dharma rejoice upon receiving it; and let the wise be gladdened at the coming of those who practice the Dharma. Let people give faith-offerings as is fitting and according to their means.

Whoever is uneasy in mind regarding another's food and drink will not attain meditative absorption, day or night. But one who cuts off all such things, as one would cut the crown of a palm tree, will attain meditative absorptions, day and night.

Just as a dry well ought not to be resorted to, so too one without faith ought not to be relied upon. Even if one were to dig thoroughly into such a person, only foul, muddy water would arise. But as a wise one draws water from a lake that is abundant, clear, cool, and free from turbidity, so let the person of wisdom seek the company of the faithful.

Whether one is attached or unattached, one should not be uncertain about the form of the Sage. Abandon those without faith; rely closely upon those with faith.

This is the tenth chapter, on faith.

In summary: impermanence, desire, craving, heedfulness, and likewise joy, moral discipline, good conduct, pure speech, action, and faith — these are the ten.

Let the brahmin thoroughly abandon desire, and with diligence cut off its stream. Without having thoroughly abandoned desire, not a single sage has attained liberation.

Those who wander about in weakness, because afflictions recur again and again — it is through diligence alone, firm and steady, that that very task is accomplished.

However many are the works of the weak, and however many the afflictions, the austerities, and the spiritual practices that are thoroughly impure — one does not think these will become something of great meaning.

Just as one who handles an arrow carelessly has his hand cut, so a monk who handles his training carelessly is led close to hell.

Just as one who handles an arrow skillfully does not have his hand cut, so a contemplative who handles his training well is led close to nirvāṇa.

When the life of a contemplative is not understood, when it is hard to cross over and hard to bear, many sufferings arise for those weak ones who will come to regret.

For one whose mind, repeatedly assailed by remorse, falls under the power of discursive thought, and who has not turned that mind around — how can one lead the life of a contemplative?

Those who go forth into wrongdoing and delight in faults, who dwell at home and engage in wrongdoing, who resort to suffering without equal — they merely accumulate the sufferings of renewed existence.

Those who wear the patchwork robe of ochre and who, for the most part, observe no true restraint, who have the character of evil and delight in evil — those evil ones go to the lower realms.

One who is deeply lax in discipline, like a creeping vine on a sāla tree — such a one wishes to act toward himself just as an enemy would.

One whose head has turned white, who has not yet entered into the way of the elder — that one has collided with youth; that one is to be called a foolish elder.

But one who has abandoned both virtue and non-virtue, who lives the holy life, and who, having abandoned factions, conducts himself accordingly — that one is to be called a true elder.

Without discipline and speaking falsehood, one is not a contemplative by the mere shaving of the head. Those who are deluded and have entered upon desire — how on earth could they be contemplatives?

Without discipline and speaking falsehood, one is not a contemplative by the mere shaving of the head. One who has pacified evil — the wise recognize that one as a contemplative.

Without discipline and speaking falsehood, one is not a contemplative by the mere shaving of the head. Those who, having examined all evils great and small, and having pacified evil — those are to be called true contemplatives.

One who has abandoned evil is a brahmin. One who pacifies is a contemplative. One who has thoroughly abandoned one's own defilements — therefore that one is called one who has gone forth.

This is the eleventh chapter, on the contemplative.

When one sees the Four Noble Truths of the noble ones with wisdom, and thoroughly understands this path, craving for existence is thoroughly dried up.

Just as wind raises dust and falling rain quiets it, so too when one sees with wisdom, conceptual thought is pacified.

Through thorough comprehension, birth and death are thoroughly exhausted, and the world is definitively distinguished — that wisdom is supreme.

Among truths, the Four Truths; among paths, the noble Eightfold Path is supreme; among the two-footed, the one with eyes; among phenomena, dispassion is supreme.

When one sees with wisdom that all formations are impermanent, one turns away from suffering; this path becomes thoroughly pure.

When one sees with wisdom that all formations are suffering, one turns away from suffering; this path becomes thoroughly pure.

When one sees with wisdom that all formations are empty, one turns away from suffering; this path becomes thoroughly pure.

When one sees with wisdom that all formations are without self, one turns away from suffering; this path becomes thoroughly pure.

This path becomes thoroughly pure. The path that cuts the thorn of craving — I have taught it to you all. The Tathāgata is the Teacher; what must be done, you must do yourselves.

The path that removes the thorn of craving — I have taught it to you all. The Tathāgata is the Teacher; what must be done, you must do yourselves.

There is no other path that thoroughly purifies the view. Therefore, rest steadily in meditative absorption (samādhi) and abandon the bonds of Māra.

This is the straight path, this is the path that crosses to the other shore, traversed as a single road, like a goose's line across a lake.

What Śākyamuni understood while in meditative equipoise, and proclaimed again and again to the assembly — this teaching, given out of loving compassion to bring beings to understand the limits of birth and death, was the supreme teaching of the single path. By this path one crosses ahead of the streams, others cross in the same way, and he causes them to cross. In order to discipline even the most intractable beings, to exhaust the birth and death of saṃsāra, and to realize individually the many different elements — the one endowed with eyes taught this path supremely.

Just as the waters of the river Ganges flow into the ocean, so too does one enter this path, taught through vast wisdom, in order to attain the deathless.

He who, out of loving compassion for all beings, turned the wheel of Dharma never heard before, he the Protector who disciplined gods and humans, who reached the far shore of existence — to him I pay homage.

One should examine the three wholesome conceptual states, and also entirely abandon the three unwholesome ones. Then, as dust stirred up everywhere is beaten down by rain, one should still the movement of discursive thought and investigation.

When conceptual agitation has been thoroughly calmed in the mind, one will touch the bliss of unsurpassed awakening (bodhi). Fix the mind on the three meditative absorptions; cultivate the boundless states born of truth. The wise one, endowed with mindfulness, should untie the knots, and through these

three, thoroughly sever the three abodes.

Armed with the sword of wisdom and the power of diligence, delighting in mindfulness, meditative equipoise, and absorption — having understood the arising and passing of the world, one who knows this is fully liberated from everything. Having thoroughly understood the world in all its extent, one who has reached the far shore of the world is said to have crossed over.

Whoever cultivates the peaceful noble path — the eightfold path — and the straight path, attains the nectar of immortality. Practicing in this way, one who desires happiness obtains happiness, attains good repute, and fame grows ever greater.

This is the twelfth chapter of verses: the chapter on the path.

The Chapter of Purposeful Sayings. The second portion.

A mule is ruined by its own womb; a bamboo shoot, by its fruit; a plantain, by its fruit — in the same way, a man of inferior character is ruined by the honors he receives.

As long as a fool receives veneration, he is utterly destroyed. The wholesome quality of the child decreases, and even his head will surely deteriorate.

Desiring to obtain what is not good, desiring a retinue of monks, being miserly about one's dwelling, being venerated by those of other lineages — whether one who has gone forth or a householder, whenever anyone courts me, thinking "let them honor me whether or not I have done anything, as long as they come under my sway" — when a fool thinks in this way, the great desire in the mind will only increase.

The means of obtaining gain is one thing, and the way to nirvāṇa is another. Knowing this as is appropriate, a monk who is a hearer (śrāvaka) of a buddha does not delight in honors, and gradually cultivates ever greater seclusion.

One should not strive for everything, not let oneself be importuned by people, not depend on others for one's livelihood, and not engage in the Dharma as if it were a trade. One should accept what one receives, and not generate desire for what belongs to others. A monk who covets what belongs to others will not attain meditative absorption.

If one wishes to live in comfort and wishes to keep this ascetic life in view, then when the Saṅgha gives robes and food and drink, one should accept them.

If one wishes to live in comfort and wishes to keep this ascetic life in view, then like a snake emerging from its hole, one should make use of one's dwelling and resting place.

If one wishes to live in comfort and wishes to keep this ascetic life in view, one should be content with even the coarsest provisions and cultivate even a single teaching alone.

If one knows little but keeps moral discipline well and steadily, those who do know will praise one's livelihood, saying there is no idleness in it.

If one possesses the three undefiled knowledges that vanquish the lord of death, it is all too easy for a fool to think "this one knows nothing at all" and slander such a person.

If a person of wicked character comes to be endowed with gains of food and drink, those around them will offer them reverence and make offerings to them.

As for the food, drink, robes, and bedding received by a shaven-headed, saffron-robed child — these yield nothing but a multitude of enemies.

Having thus fully understood the grave dangers of honors, having contracted one's fears and contained one's anxious thoughts, let a mindful monk wander everywhere.

Though a diet of rough food may not pacify the mind, one should not eat or act merely for the sake of this life. Understanding that food sustains the body, one should range among alms-rounds accordingly.

The reverence paid with clasped hands by those of good family — this is a subtle thorn, hard to extract. The honors that are so hard for people to bear — understand them thoroughly to be like a swamp.

This was the thirteenth chapter, on the thicket of honors.

Not committing sinful actions, not stealing from those whom one should not steal from — in this world and the next, such a person is not stained by evil.

One who first ruins oneself and then ruins others, like a hawk that seizes meat and destroys it — ruins both oneself and others.

One who strikes receives blows in return. One who bears resentment meets resentment. Likewise one who scolds is scolded in return, and one who angers others brings anger upon oneself.

There are other childish ascetics here who are unskilled in the noble Dharma. Throughout their entire brief lives they hold grudges even over mere mockery. Thinking "I am supreme," each speaks separately, and by pushing their factions forward, when the Saṅgha is being split, why do they not make a powerless mind?

Breaking bones, taking life, plundering horses, cattle, and wealth, and destroying villages and districts — all of this is later measured out as fitting repayment.

If one understands this Dharma, whose words were examined and proclaimed by the wise and which shows the sphere of conduct, why would you all not do it?

You are someone without skill and with habits of that kind, striving with mere words of the mouth. Because your opponents do not know, I apply myself to this.

Those who are skilled here, with pacifying words held in check — those who scold me, scold me and say "I am defeated, I am defeated." Whoever grasps that thought in mind — their resentment will not be stilled.

Those who scold me, scold me and say "I am defeated, I am defeated" — whoever does not grasp that thought in mind — their resentment will be stilled.

In this world those who are full of resentment will never be stilled through resentment. It is through patience that resentment is stilled — this is the very nature of the Dharma.

Those who are full of resentment are never stilled through resentment. Those without resentment bring resentment to stillness. Since rancor that has entered the flesh harms the embodied being, therefore the wise should not hold resentment.

If one finds a companion who is steadfast, excellent in character, and agreeable to live with — a wise friend — then having fully subdued all afflictions, one should live with that person with a mindful and joyful mind.

If one does not find a companion who is steadfast, excellent in character, and agreeable to live with — a wise friend — then, like a king who has abandoned his populous realm, one should wander alone and not commit evil.

If one does not come to find a good companion who is congenial in conduct with oneself, one should not take a childish person as a companion.

One should make solitary conduct steadfast. Since one does not take a childish person as a companion, and since it is easier to walk alone, one should wander alone, with a collected and settled mind, like an elephant alone in the forest of Mātāṅga.

This is the fourteenth chapter, "On Companionship."

Just as the Buddha has taught, one who is mindful of the in-breath and out-breath, having well cultivated that practice to full completion, is gradually and thoroughly purified, and in this world shines forth on all sides like the sun and moon free of clouds.

Whether walking, sitting, or likewise lying down, settling both body and mind — when a monk thus well establishes mindfulness, he will attain distinction in earlier and later moments of practice. And having attained distinction in those earlier and later moments, he will pass beyond, unseen even by the King of Death.

Having closely established mindfulness with awareness of the body, and having restrained the six sense bases of contact, one who always abides in meditative equipoise will, by one's own effort, realize nirvāṇa.

One who always and in every respect closely establishes mindfulness with awareness of the body — without a self and without grasping at a self — will not become a self, will not grasp at a self. Thus a monk who quickly enters meditative equipoise will cross beyond craving for sense objects.

One who practices with mindfulness, vigilance, and meditative equipoise — with joy and with clarity, again and again — who applies diligence to this Dharma, will, it is said, cross beyond birth and aging.

Therefore, always applying diligence and striving, a monk who is learned, mindful, and energetic, having abandoned clinging in every birth, thereby attains nirvāṇa in this very life.

"Let the firefly that awakens those who sleep — hear from me. Through lying down it is easy to be a firefly; there is no fear in being a firefly. One who strives to be a firefly, who trains by day and by night, with aspiration set upon the deathless, will consume the defilements.

One who by day and by night recollects the Buddha — those who have gone to the Buddha for refuge — they are the finest of human gains.

One who by day and by night recollects the Dharma — those who have gone to the Dharma for refuge — they are the finest of human gains.

One who by day and by night recollects the Saṅgha — those who have gone to the Saṅgha for refuge — they are the finest of human gains.

One who by day and by night recollects the Buddha — that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night recollects the Dharma — that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night recollects the Saṅgha — that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night recollects moral discipline — that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night recollects generosity — that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night recollects the gods — that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night always maintains mindfulness with awareness of the body — that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night always recollects the four meditative absorptions — that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night delights in non-harming — that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night delights in the absence of ill-will — that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night delights in meditation —
that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night delights in emptiness —
that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night delights in the signless —
that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night delights in seclusion —
that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night delights in renunciation —
that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night delights in nothingness —
that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

One who by day and by night delights in nirvāṇa —
that śrāvaka of Gautama will awaken with true and excellent wakefulness.

This is the fifth chapter, on mindfulness.

When one's task is stirred by the urgency of what must be done, take up that task's fire at the very first moment. If I act accordingly from the outset, I shall wish to complete the task as its urgency demands, and things will come about just as desired. Seeing that this is the nature of things, for as long as the undertaking can be brought to fullness, a person must exert himself. Through striving and diligent effort, make yourself an island of refuge. As a smith refines silver, purify your own impurities. When impurities have been cleansed, faults no longer arise, and thereafter birth and old age are not obtained.

One who feels shame over what is not shameful, and feels no shame over what is truly shameful; who sees danger where there is none and sees no danger where there truly is — by taking up such wrong views, a sentient being goes to an unfortunate destiny.

But one who was formerly heedless and later becomes heedful shines upon this world in all directions, like the sun and moon freed from clouds. And one who was formerly heedless and later becomes heedful shall pass beyond craving in this world through mindfulness, and shall pass beyond it well.

One who goes forth in youth and enters into the teaching of the Buddha shines upon this world in all directions, like the sun and moon freed from clouds. One who goes forth in youth and enters into the teaching of the Buddha shall pass beyond craving in this world through mindfulness, and shall pass beyond it well.

One who has committed harmful actions and covers them over with virtue shines upon this world in all directions, like the sun and moon freed from

clouds. One who has committed harmful actions and covers them over with virtue shall pass beyond craving in this world through mindfulness, and shall pass beyond it well.

One who takes no delight in living — even in death that person has no grief. One who sees the stable state of liberation does not burn even in the midst of sorrow. One who takes no delight in living — even in death that person has no grief. One who sees the stable state of liberation sits at ease even in the midst of kinsmen longing for reunion.

O monk, cultivate the white Dharma and completely abandon the dark dharmas. Having gone from home into homelessness, train yourself with keen delight in whatever constitutes a secluded sphere of conduct, give up every last desire, always keep the heart pure, always keep the restoration ceremony pure, and let your conduct in purifying actions be pure — then your ascetic practice will be perfectly accomplished.

Just as weeds are the bane of a field, so attachment is the bane of the people of this world. Therefore, giving to those who are free from attachment brings great fruit.

Just as weeds are the bane of a field, so aversion is the bane of the people of this world. Therefore, giving to those who are free from aversion brings great fruit.

Just as weeds are the bane of a field, so delusion is the bane of the people of this world. Therefore, giving to those who are free from delusion brings great fruit.

Just as weeds are the bane of a field, so pride is the bane of the people of this world. Therefore, giving to those who are free from pride brings great fruit.

Just as weeds are the bane of a field, so attachment is the bane of the people of this world. Therefore, giving to those who are free from attachment brings great fruit.

Just as weeds are the bane of a field, so craving is the bane of the people of this world. Therefore, giving to those who are free from craving brings great fruit.

The sixth group: the master is the king. When one becomes attached, one is a being of attachment. When one is without attachment, still one has attachment. Attachment is called childishness.

Where attachment, aversion, pride, and concealment dwell, that city is walled with bones, plastered over with flesh and blood, born of suffering, stirred up from within by causes. Those who do not see this remain bound there. Those who understand it utterly abandon the floods. Those who cling to what is external cannot abandon them.

This is the sixteenth sub-group of verses.

Those who have no delight in the household, who strive with mindfulness, abandon the household and cross the flood, just as a swan departs from a foul lake.

Having renounced the world with firm resolve and utterly defeated the armies of Māra, they go through the sky by miraculous power, like swans along the path of the sun.

Those who have not lived the holy life, who in youth have not won wealth, lie like aged herons on a fishless bank at the edge of a foul lake.

Those who have not lived the holy life, who in youth have not won wealth, lie curled up recalling what they did in former times.

Think not that a little non-virtue will not come back to you hereafter. Drop by drop falling water fills even a great vessel. So it is that a fool is filled with non-virtue accumulated little by little.

Think not that a little virtue will not come back to you hereafter. Drop by drop falling water fills even a great vessel. So it is that a steadfast one is filled with virtue accumulated little by little.

One who has abandoned the foul lake of accumulated filth and wishes to cross the great ocean of waters: though ordinary people may raft across, the wise one crosses it.

Having crossed, the Blessed One, the buddha, dwells on dry ground as a brahmin. The monks bathe there, and the hearers too construct a raft.

Just as the great deep lakes are utterly still and free of turbidity, so the truly wise, with depth, listen to this Dharma.

Since there is water everywhere, who would seek it out and wander searching? What need is there for well water? Cut craving off at its root.

Just as potters wash with water, just as archers straighten shafts with fire, and just as carpenters dress the wood, so the wise one disciplines the self.

Like the sky, free from attachment; like a threshold, unshaken; like a turbid lake, the wise one takes no delight in cyclic existence.

This is the seventeenth sub-group of verses on water.

Who excels in this world together with its gods and the realm of Yama? Who is skilled in teaching well the four qualities so eagerly desired, like a flower?

Who excels in this world together with its gods and the realm of Yama, among those who are learners? Who is skilled in teaching well the four qualities so eagerly desired, like a flower?

Because fear arises from the forest, cut the forest — but not the tree. From forest and the bond of forest being cut, the ascetic will pass beyond sorrow.

For as long as the bond of forest is not cut, even in its finest form it will grow back in people. Like a calf longing for its mother's milk, that mind becomes thoroughly bound.

Like cutting away with one's hand the autumnal lotus, with delight in the self severed, cultivate the very path of peace, for the sake of the nirvāṇa spoken of by the Victor.

Just as a lovely flower

with no fruit — do not leave it so.

Just as a bee, without harming the flower's color and fragrance, takes up the nectar and flies away, so let the sage move through a village. Do not examine the faults of others, or what others have done and not done. By oneself alone, examine what is fitting and what is not fitting.

Just as from a heap of discarded rags amid impure water, a lotus blooms open — pure, fragrant, and delightful — so too, from this heap of discarded rags that are ordinary beings sunk in blindness, the śrāvakas of the perfectly awakened buddhas shine forth, illumined by wisdom.

Just as from a heap of flowers many garlands are made, so too a person born into humanity should perform abundant virtuous deeds.

Just as in summer the flowers of the kanikāra tree scatter and fall in profusion, so too, monks, abandon attachment, aversion, and delusion.

The minds of human beings are variously scattered like flowers, gathered in great abundance — and the lord of death takes them and moves on, as a great flood carries away a sleeping village.

The minds of human beings are variously scattered like flowers, gathered in great abundance — unsatisfied by objects of desire, they are brought under the power of the lord of death.

The minds of human beings are variously scattered like flowers, gathered in great abundance — their enjoyments never come to fullness, and they are brought under the power of the lord of death.

The minds of human beings are variously scattered like flowers, gathered in great abundance — their tasks brought to no conclusion, and they are brought under the power of the lord of death.

Having understood this body to be like a bee, and having known phenomena likewise to be like a mirage, cutting here the choicest flower of Māra, one passes beyond unseen even by the king, the lord of death.

Having understood these worlds to be like a bee, and having known phenomena likewise to be like a mirage, cutting here the choicest flower of Māra, one passes beyond unseen even by the king, the lord of death.

Having understood this body to be like a bubble, and having known phenomena likewise to be like a mirage, cutting here the choicest flower of Māra, one passes beyond unseen even by the king, the lord of death.

Having understood these worlds to be like a bubble, and having known phenomena likewise to be like a mirage, cutting here the choicest flower of Māra, one passes beyond unseen even by the king, the lord of death.

Whatever monk reflects that existence is like the udumbara flower — without essence — that monk goes to the far shore that is not the far shore, abandoning, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a water-born flower rooted in the water, whatever monk cuts attachment without remainder — that monk goes to the far shore that is not the far shore, abandoning, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a water-born flower rooted in the water, whatever monk cuts aversion without remainder — that monk goes to the far shore that is not the far shore, abandoning, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a water-born flower rooted in the water, whatever monk cuts delusion without remainder — that monk goes to the far shore that is not the far shore, abandoning, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a water-born flower rooted in the water, whatever monk cuts pride without remainder — that monk goes to the far shore that is not the far shore, abandoning, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a water-born flower rooted in the water, whatever monk cuts clinging without remainder — that monk goes to the far shore that is not the far shore, abandoning, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a water-born flower rooted in the water, whatever monk cuts craving without remainder — that monk goes to the far shore that is not the far shore, abandoning, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

This is the eighteenth chapter, the cluster on flowers.

Just as a fine horse, when touched by the whip,
startles and moves forward with great speed —
so those who are endowed with faith, moral discipline, and meditative absorption,
who have the determination to settle all phenomena definitively,
whose faculties are balanced, who are patient, and who are pleasant companions:
those protectors abandon craving without remainder.

Just as a fine horse, when touched by the whip,
startles and moves forward with great speed —
so those protectors who are endowed with faith, moral discipline, and meditative absorption,
who have the determination to settle all phenomena definitively,
who possess knowledge and conduct, and who are endowed with mindfulness:
they bring about the abandonment of suffering without remainder.

Like a well-trained horse — so let the one who is a trainer,
whoever restrains the sense faculties well,
abandoning anger and bringing the defilements to exhaustion —
those capable ones experience a state even among the gods.

Through heedfulness, over heedlessness;
through great wakefulness, over those who sleep;
a fine horse, over a wild horse —
the supremely wise one, having abandoned, goes onward.

For a fine horse, as with the whip,
whoever relies on a sense of shame

and wisdom well-composed in equanimity —
that one dispels wrongdoing.

The tamed one proceeds to the intended place
and rides the king of the tamed, supremely.
Whoever does not speak harshly —
among humans, the tamed one is supreme.

Among elephants, the great elephant;
among the horses of Sindhu, the thoroughbred;
and whoever is the tamer of mules —
even finer than these is the taming of oneself.

For whoever is truly well-tamed
in oneself, that wise one attains peace;
but those who are merely riders —
that ground they can never reach.

Among elephants, the great elephant;
among the horses of Sindhu, the thoroughbred;
and whoever is the tamer of mules —
even finer than these is the taming of oneself.

Whoever is well-tamed in oneself, endowed with mindfulness —
that one brings suffering to its final end;
but those who are merely riders —
that ground they can never reach.

Among elephants, the great elephant;
among the horses of Sindhu, the thoroughbred;
and whoever is the tamer of mules —
even finer than these is the taming of oneself.

Whoever is well-tamed in oneself, endowed with mindfulness —
that one shall abandon all the destinies of beings;
but those who are merely riders —
that ground they can never reach.

Among elephants, the great elephant;
among the horses of Sindhu, the thoroughbred;
and whoever is the tamer of mules —
even finer than these is the taming of oneself.

Whoever is well-tamed in oneself —
that one, having cut the bonds, goes onward;
but those who are merely riders —
that ground they can never reach.

Like a fine horse that a trainer tames,
tame oneself and oneself alone.
Through taming oneself thoroughly,
one reaches the far shore beyond all suffering.

Oneself alone is one's own protector;
oneself alone is one's own refuge.
Like a fine horse that a trainer tames,
tame oneself, therefore, above all else.

This is the nineteenth chapter, the cluster on horses.

Whoever abandons anger and utterly relinquishes pride,
passes entirely beyond all bonds and fetters,
clings neither to name nor to form —
since they have nothing, they do not fall under the sway of clinging.

Cast off anger the very moment it arises;
once arisen, abandon attachment.
Through steadiness, fully abandon ignorance.
When one sees truth, one becomes happy.

When anger is abandoned, one sleeps at ease.
When anger is abandoned, one does not burn.
O monk, cut out the very root
of anger, that destroyer of happiness and poison —
the noble ones will then praise you,
and having cut it, you will be free from sorrow.

Whoever, when angry, declares of a good deed done for them
that it was not good — that one, beneath the calm of anger,
is scorched as if burned by fire.

The one who is shameless and without conscience,
who is angry, has no discipline.
One who is utterly overpowered by anger —
no one takes refuge in such a person.

Whoever possesses the power of a child:
that power is in truth no power at all.
A child, devoid of Dharma —

there is yet a task to be accomplished.
One who is possessed of power
and yet endures those of lesser strength —
that, it is said, is the supreme patience.
Always bow, like one who is humble.

One who has become a master of others
and yet endures those of lesser strength —
that, it is said, is the supreme patience.
Always bow, like one who is humble.

One who is powerful
and yet endures when greatly reviled by others —
that, it is said, is the supreme patience.
Always bow, like one who is humble.

One who is powerful
and yet endures when greatly scorned by others —
that, it is said, is the supreme patience.
Always bow, like one who is humble.

One who, knowing that another is angry,
brings peace close within themselves —
that person protects both themselves
and others from great terrors.

One who, knowing that another is angry,
brings peace close within themselves —
that person serves the welfare
of both themselves and others.

The one who acts for the welfare of both themselves and others —
those who are unlearned in Dharma
may easily take them for a mere child.

Words spoken by one of higher station are endured out of fear,
words of a rival are endured to avoid provoking a fight —
but one who endures the words of an inferior:
that one the holy ones have proclaimed as the highest in patience.

A child, in anger, speaks rough words,
thinking thereby to gain the upper hand.
One who endures such words —
that one is forever the true victor.

Speak the truth; do not be angry;
give even a little to one who asks.
By these three foundations
one goes to the realm of the gods.

A person who is overpowered by the torrent of anger
fails to discern even their own purpose;
therefore, in the midst of your retinue, exercise care —
speak words that are free from anger.

One who returns anger with anger
thereby becomes a wrongdoer.
Therefore, do not return anger with anger —
and you will win the victory in a battle hard to win.

Overcome anger by non-anger,
overcome what is not good by what is good,
overcome the miser by generosity,
overcome the false by truth.

Dwelling in discipline and reason,
living without anger — how could such a one be angry?
The wise who are liberated through true understanding
are free from anger.

Without anger, without harm —
noble persons (āryas) may always dwell with one such as this;
but sinful beings overpowered by anger
are bent low, like mountains under weight.

One who, when anger arises,
holds it back like a chariot run loose —
that one I call a trainer of horses;
others are merely those who hold the reins.

This is the twentieth chapter, the Chapter on Anger.

A summary verse:
The path of renunciation, veneration,

craving, and the fifth — mindfulness —
droplets of water, flowers,
horses, and anger — these make ten.

Who in this world knows all and overcomes all,
unstained by any of these phenomena,
who has utterly abandoned all, whose craving is exhausted, thoroughly
liberated —
who could teach one who has known this by themselves?

The Tathāgata, Teacher of gods and humans,
I who possess all powers and am omniscient,
who having attained awakening have taught it by myself —
who could teach me, the peerless and incomparable?

I am the arhat of the world.
In the world, I am supreme and unexcelled;
in the world together with its gods
I, the Victor, have conquered all the māras.

Since there is none equal to me,
I have no teacher of any kind.
In this world, by myself alone,
I have attained unsurpassed and perfect awakening.

Know that whoever has attained the exhaustion of all defilements
is like me, the Victor.

Having triumphed over sinful phenomena through the pride of victory —
therefore I am a victor through rightful pride.

The omniscient buddha, who has passed beyond sorrow,
who has crossed beyond craving for the objects of the world —
since the people of the world did not know the arising of all things
without being taught,

I went to Vārāṇasī,
and there I beat the drum of Dharma,
and I turned the wheel of Dharma —
that wheel which no one in the world had turned before.

Thus the Tathāgatas, those heroes —

here they tamed beings through the Dharma. No wise person censures those who have been tamed by the Dharma. Those who are steadfast, who have entered meditative absorption, who delight in the peace of renunciation, who hold to the final body — those fully awakened buddhas of great renown, swift in wisdom: they bring joy to gods and humans alike.

The buddhas of the past, the buddhas yet to come, and the fully awakened buddhas of the present, who have dispelled the sorrow of the many — all those who have dwelt, who dwell, and who will likewise dwell: this that they have made the holy Dharma supreme is the very nature of reality of the fully awakened buddhas. Therefore I rejoice in this, and with the wish for the great self, I have called to mind the teaching of the buddhas: make the holy Dharma supreme.

Whatever person, childish and foolish, does not generate faith in the teaching of the buddhas — that one will go to a place of ruin, like a merchant set upon by ogresses. But whatever person, endowed with wisdom, generates faith in the teaching of the buddhas — that one will go in happiness to the far shore, like a merchant supported by a vigorous wind.

The Tathāgata, unequalled and incomparable —
the buddhas who travel in two kinds of thought,
the thought of bliss and the thought of utter solitude,
have gone beyond to the far shore, dispelling darkness, endowed with renown.
They have gained what is to be gained and have mastered the mind.
Completely liberated, their defilements exhausted, supremely and fully freed —

those who are freed in mind, who are ultimate, who are undefiled,
look upon embodied beings of the world for their benefit.
Just as one who, having seated oneself on a mountain peak,
looks out upon all the people in every direction —
so too the wise ones, free from sorrow,
having ascended to the mansion born of Dharma,
survey from all around those beings afflicted and overwhelmed
by birth, old age, and sorrow;
and with the intention to open for them the door to the deathless,
dispel the doubts of those who wish to listen.

This is the twenty-first chapter: On the Tathāgata.

Listening well and acting well,
going forth rightly from the home,
thoroughly surrounded by those who practice renunciation —
this is excellent, befitting a renunciant.

The childish and unwise live as though they were immortal,
while the wise treat the holy Dharma as a patient treats illness in the night.

Just as when one enters a well-roofed house
covered in darkness —
though forms are present there,
one with eyes cannot see them —
so too here, a person of good family,
even if endowed with intelligence,
will not know virtuous and non-virtuous phenomena
until they have been heard.

Just as one who has eyes and a lamp
can see forms as they truly are,
so too virtuous and non-virtuous phenomena
are discerned through listening.

Through listening, phenomena are discerned.
Through listening, one turns back from non-virtue.
Through listening, one abandons the meaningless.
Through listening, one attains nirvāṇa.

Even if one has heard a great deal,
if one does not restrain moral discipline well,
one is censured for one's moral discipline,
and that person's learning is not excellent.

Even if one has heard but little,
if one restrains moral discipline well,
one is praised for one's moral discipline,
and that person's learning becomes excellent.

One who has heard little
and does not restrain moral discipline well —
that one is censured for both,
and their conduct and observances are not excellent.

One who has heard much
and who restrains moral discipline well —
that one is praised for both,

and their conduct and observances become excellent.

One who has heard much, who upholds the Dharma,
who is endowed with wisdom and who is in meditative equipoise —
such a one is worthy of censure by none,
like an ornament of gold from Jambudvīpa.

As for one who judges by physical form
and measures me by sound,
one imbued with the attachment of desire —

that person does not know me. If one knows within but does not come to see outwardly, then whoever sees the inner fruit — that one may be summoned by sound. If one sees outwardly but does not come to know within, then whoever sees the outer fruit — that one may be summoned by sound. If one neither knows within nor comes to see outwardly, those utterly obscured by childishness — they too may be summoned by sound. But if one knows within and also sees outwardly, possessed of wisdom and the teaching of renunciation — that one may rightly be summoned by sound.

Even if one hears a great deal with the ears and sees much with the eyes, it is not fitting to place trust in all that is seen and heard of the teaching. One who knows that well-spoken words are the essence, and who knows that meditative absorption is the essence, yet who acts carelessly and arrogantly — for that one, hearing and understanding will not become of great benefit.

One who delights in the Dharma taught by the noble ones and acts accordingly in body and speech, who is endowed with patience, who delights in companionship, whose sense faculties are restrained — such a one attains the perfection of hearing and understanding.

This is the twenty-second chapter, on the topic of hearing.

Train in what is well spoken, pay respect to ascetics, seek solitude, take a single seat, and bring the mind to calm. A single seat, a single bed; practice alone without indolence; dwell alone in the forest; tame oneself alone.

One who conquers a thousand thousand men in battle — whoever conquers oneself conquers better in battle. The one who always practices restraint, who subdues oneself alone, who conquers oneself — that is the supreme victory; the rest is merely the common view of ordinary people.

A monk established in wisdom who has conquered — māra together with Brahmā cannot defeat him. Neither by gods nor by those who live on fragrance.

First establish oneself in what is proper; then afterwards tame others as one would oneself. Having first established oneself in what is proper, when the time comes to tame others, the wise one is not afflicted by the mental afflictions. Just as one does to oneself, so too do to others. Tame oneself, and through being calm, tame others with ease. Just as one does to oneself, so too do to others.

Ah, how good it is to tame oneself well! One who has tamed oneself becomes joyful. For the sake of one's own good, one should relinquish the good of many others as well. If one comes to understand greatly the purpose of oneself, that becomes supreme in serving one's own good.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, the wise one attains all aims.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, the wise one attains all Dharma.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, the wise one attains renown.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, the wise one attains happiness.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, the wise one attains a happy rebirth.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, one rejoices long in the higher realms.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, one shines brilliantly among one's kindred.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, one is not tormented in the midst of sorrow.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there?

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, one cuts through every bond.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, one abandons every lower realm.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, one is utterly liberated from all suffering.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Having made oneself one's own protector, one attains the state of being one's own protector.

Oneself is one's own protector — what other protector is there? Oneself is one's own protector — one draws close to nirvāṇa itself.

This is the twenty-third chapter of verses.

Better than a hundred verses of words devoid of meaning is a single word of meaning that brings peace upon hearing it.

Better than a hundred verses of words devoid of Dharma is a single word of Dharma that brings peace upon hearing it.

Better than living a hundred years without moral discipline and without meditative equipoise is living even a few days possessed of moral discipline and meditative equipoise.

Better than living a hundred years without diligence, burdened with laziness, is living even a few days having firmly undertaken diligence.

Better than living a hundred years without wisdom, without meditative equipoise, is living even a few days with great wisdom in meditative equipoise.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing arising and passing away is living even a few days seeing arising and passing away.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing the exhaustion of feeling is living even a few days seeing the exhaustion of feeling.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing the exhaustion of defilements is living even a few days seeing the exhaustion of defilements.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing the unshakeable attainment is living even a few days seeing the unshakeable attainment.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing the attainment hard to behold is living even a few days seeing the attainment hard to behold.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing the lofty attainment is living even a few days seeing the lofty attainment.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing the supreme attainment is living even a few days seeing the supreme attainment.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing the deathless attainment is living even a few days seeing the deathless attainment.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing the nectar-like attainment is living even a few days seeing the nectar-like attainment.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing the dustless attainment is living even a few days seeing the dustless attainment.

Better than living a hundred years without seeing the stainless attainment is living even a few days seeing the stainless attainment.

One who lives a hundred years in the forest tending a sacred fire does not equal a sixteenth part of the offering made by one who meditates upon oneself even for a single moment. Performing a fire sacrifice for a hundred years is not worth it.

Whatever merit one who eats only kuśa-grass tips each month may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the faith in the Buddha.

Whatever merit one who eats only kuśa-grass tips each month may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the faith in the sacred Dharma.

Whatever merit one who eats only kuśa-grass tips each month may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the faith in the Saṅgha.

Whatever merit one who eats only kuśa-grass tips each month may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the compassion one feels toward sentient beings.

Whatever merit one who eats only kuśa-grass tips each month may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the compassion one feels toward living creatures.

Whatever merit one who eats only kuśa-grass tips each month may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the compassion one feels toward elemental spirits.

Whatever merit one who eats only kuśa-grass tips each month may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the merit of one who cultivates a mind of

loving-kindness.

Whatever merit one who eats only kuśa-grass tips each month may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the sacred Dharma so well proclaimed.

Whatever merit one who performs a thousand fire sacrifices each month for a hundred years may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the faith in the Buddha.

Whatever merit one who performs a thousand fire sacrifices each month for a hundred years may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the faith in the sacred Dharma.

Whatever merit one who performs a thousand fire sacrifices each month for a hundred years may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the faith in the Saṅgha.

Whatever merit one who performs a thousand fire sacrifices each month for a hundred years may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the compassion one feels toward sentient beings.

Whatever merit one who performs a thousand fire sacrifices each month for a hundred years may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the compassion one feels toward living creatures.

Whatever merit one who performs a thousand fire sacrifices each month for a hundred years may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the compassion one feels toward elemental spirits.

Whatever merit one who performs a thousand fire sacrifices each month for a hundred years may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the merit of one who cultivates a mind of loving-kindness.

Whatever merit one who performs a thousand fire sacrifices each month for a hundred years may gain does not equal even a sixteenth part of the sacred Dharma so well proclaimed.

Whatever small fire sacrifices or offerings a person seeking merit performs in this world — these do not equal even a fourth part of the merit of one who pays homage with a sincere and upright mind.

This was the twenty-fourth chapter, the chapter on comparison.

The Chapter of Intentional Sayings. The third section.

Do not associate with those who lack faith and are arrogant,
with those who are divisive and given to slander,
who are not befriended by the wise —
do not keep company with wicked people.

Associate with those who have faith and speak pleasantly,
who have heard much and possess moral discipline,
who are befriended by the wise —
keep company with the most excellent of people.

Do not rely upon wicked companions;
do not resort to bad people.
Rely upon virtuous spiritual friends;
resort to noble persons.

When one relies upon such as these,
one will not fall into wrongdoing but will come to what is good.

The person who is relied upon by others — one who has heard much,
contemplated much,
who possesses faith and wisdom — if here one listens to the good words
spoken by such a person,
one will come to distinction even over a long time.

Relying upon the inferior, a person deteriorates.
Relying upon one's equal, one remains where one is.
Relying upon the superior, one will come to what is excellent.
Therefore rely upon those who are one's betters.

If one relies upon a superior who is endowed
with moral discipline that brings deep peace,
and with wisdom of the very highest order,
one will come to be more excellent than even that superior.

Just as when a person in this world wraps a rotten fish in kuśa grass,
even the kuśa grass itself will begin to smell foul —
so too does it go with those who rely upon the wicked.

Just as when a person wraps fragrant sandalwood in leaves,
even the leaves themselves become sweetly scented —
so too does it go with those who rely upon the noble.

Even if those who do wrong associate with those who do no wrong,
suspicion of wrongdoing will still arise,

and their ill-repute will only spread.

A person who relies upon one unworthy of reliance
will themselves become tainted by that one's faults —
just as an arrow placed in a quiver smeared with poison
will contaminate even an arrow that was never poisoned.

Fearing the taint of such association,
do not befriend the wicked.

Just as one relies upon a companion,
just as one draws close and keeps their company —
in not so long a time, one comes to be
exactly like the one upon whom one relies.

Therefore, knowing well what one relies upon,
as one would know a vessel fit to hold the fruit,
do not rely upon those who are not noble,
but rely, with wisdom, upon the noble.

If a monk follows the path of one such as that —
one who is wise and noble —
he will attain the exhaustion of suffering.

As long as a fool lives, even if he relies upon the wise,
he will not come to know the Dharma —
just as a ladle cannot taste the flavor of the broth.

But one endowed with wisdom (prajñā), even through a brief association with
the wise,
will come to know those teachings —
just as a tongue knows the flavor of the broth at once.

As long as a fool lives, even if he relies upon the wise,
he will not come to know the teachings,
for he lacks the eye to see them.

But one endowed with wisdom, even through a brief association with the wise,
will come to know the teachings fully,
for he possesses the eye to see them.

As long as a fool lives, even if he relies upon the wise,
he will not come to know the teachings

that were taught by the fully awakened buddha (samyaksaṃbuddha).

But one endowed with wisdom, even through a brief association with the wise,
will come to know the teachings
that were taught by the fully awakened buddha.

A single word full of meaning
can accomplish the work of the wise.
Yet even the words of all the buddhas
cannot accomplish the work of the fool.

One possessed of intelligence will, from a single word,
come to understand a hundred words.
But for a fool, even a thousand words
will not bring understanding of a single one.

Since it is easy to fail to befriend the wise,
it is not right to befriend fools.

Befriending fools
leads sentient beings straight to the hells.

The fool who knows himself to be a fool —
he, here in this world, is the wise one.
The fool who thinks himself wise —
he is the one truly called a fool.

Between praise from a fool
and censure from the wise,
censure from the wise is far the better;
praise from a fool is not fitting.

Associating with fools is suffering,
and in every respect they are like enemies.
Not hearing fools, not seeing them,
not having relied upon them at all — that is what is right.

Just as meeting with a kinsman brings joy,
so does it bring happiness to rely upon the steadfast.
Therefore, as the moon travels the path of the stars,
rely upon those who are steadfast and vastly learned,
who are distinguished guides,
who possess moral discipline and noble conduct,

who are the finest of persons — loving and wise.

This is the twenty-fifth chapter, on the circle of friends and companions.

Like a tortoise withdrawing its limbs into its shell,
let the monk withdraw the mind's wandering thoughts within,
free from reliance on externals and from harming others —
let no one find occasion to reproach one who has passed beyond sorrow.

Patience is the supreme austerity; patience is nirvāṇa —
the Buddha declares: "Nirvāṇa is supreme."

One who has gone forth but harms others,
who injures others — such a one is no true ascetic.

Speak no harsh word whatsoever.
If you speak harshly, the other will answer in kind.
Contentious words bring suffering,
and retribution will cut one back in return.

If one strikes out in retaliation,
it is like striking a bronze vessel with a clapper —
one will long experience in saṃsāra
birth and old age, on and on.

But if one does not strike out in retaliation,
like a bronze vessel left unstruck —
then no quarrel will arise,
and one will attain nirvāṇa.

Freedom from illness is the supreme gain;
contentment is the wealth of wealth;
a trusted friend is the supreme companion;
nirvāṇa is the supreme bliss.

The formations (saṃskāra) are suffering and base,
hunger unbearable is among the foremost afflictions.
Knowing this just as it is,
nirvāṇa becomes the supreme.

Those who go to the higher realms are few;
those who go to the lower realms are beyond reckoning.
If one truly perceives such a danger as this,
one will swiftly attain nirvāṇa.

Going to the higher realms has its cause,
going to the lower realms has its cause,
going to nirvāṇa has its cause —
all of these, every one, have their causes.

Wild deer go where forests are finest;
birds take to the open sky;
those who have cultivated the Dharma go on,
and arhats go to nirvāṇa.

Here in this world, those with feeble diligence,
with little intelligence and without understanding,
who have not cut through all the knots —
such ones will not attain nirvāṇa.

Just as you bail out the water from this boat
and it becomes light thereby,
so likewise abandon aversion and attachment,
and then you will attain nirvāṇa.

What has arisen before ceases to arise,
and what has not arisen will come to arise;
what has not arisen will not come to arise,
and what arises now does not exist either.

Hard to behold, boundless, not seen there;
fully realizing the truth and knowing it,
seeing that there is no craving and no joy —
such a thing as this is the end of suffering.

The severing of cravings,
the thorough abandonment of attachment,
the drying up of the lake so that nothing flows —
such a thing as this is the end of suffering.

The body decayed, sensation cooled,
perception ceased and formations stilled,
consciousness extinguished —
such a thing as this is the end of suffering.

Merely seeing with the eye of vision,
merely hearing with the act of listening,
merely knowing with the act of cognizing,

and merely consciousness with consciousness —
such a thing as this is the end of suffering.

Tormented by this, burned and deeply burned —
such a thing as this is the end of suffering.

The mother not longed for, not delighted in, fully at peace,
free entirely from attachment —
such a thing as this is the end of suffering.

When there is a support, there is engagement.

When there is engagement, there is inclination.

When there is inclination, there is failure to become fully trained.

When there is failure to become fully trained, there is coming and going.

When there is coming and going, there is the taking up of death and
transference elsewhere.

When death and transference elsewhere are taken up, then there arise birth
elsewhere, and aging, and sickness, and death, and sorrow, and lamentation,
and suffering, and mental unhappiness, and disturbance — and thus this entire
great mass of suffering comes to arise.

When there is no support, there is no engagement.

When there is no engagement, there is no inclination.

When there is no inclination, there is full training.

When there is full training, there is no coming and going.

When there is no coming and going, there is no taking up of death and
transference elsewhere.

When there is no taking up of death and transference elsewhere, then birth
elsewhere, and aging, and sickness, and death, and sorrow, and lamentation,
and suffering, and mental unhappiness, and disturbance all cease — and thus
this entire great mass of suffering ceases.

Monks, there is what is unborn, unarisen, unmade, uncompounded, and
non-arising. There is what is born, arisen, artificial, intentionally made,
compounded, and dependently originated.

Monks, if what is unborn, unarisen, unmade, uncompounded, and non-arising
did not exist, then I would not say that there is an escape from what is born,
arisen, artificial, compounded, intentionally made, and dependently
originated.

Monks, because there is what is unborn, unarisen, unmade, uncompounded, and non-arising, therefore I do say that there is an escape from what is born, arisen, artificial, compounded, intentionally made, and dependently originated.

The born, the arisen, the arising,
the artificial, the compounded — unstable,
subject to aging, death, and delusion...

things subject to thorough destruction,
arising from the stream of nutriment —
do not delight in that which is destined to fall apart.

The ground of definitive emergence from it
is the stilling of discursive thought and examination,
the cessation of phenomena that are suffering —
the stilling of formations close at hand is bliss.

Monks, that which is nirvāṇa abides nowhere at all. It does not abide in earth, nor in water, nor in fire, nor in wind, nor in the sense base of infinite space, nor in the sense base of infinite consciousness, nor in the sense base of nothingness, nor in the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception. It does not abide in this world, nor in the world beyond. It does not abide in the sun or in the moon. I have directly known it as being without any referential object.

Monks, of that I do not say there is going or coming. It does not remain. Of that I do not say there is dying. It is not born. Such as it is, this is the end of suffering.

Abiding in none of earth, water, fire, or wind,
it is not illumined by brightness,
nor is there any darkness there.

The moon does not shine upon it,
nor does the sun make it manifest.

It is known by the sage, the brahmin, by himself alone.

Released entirely from form and the formless,
from all suffering — this is consummate, fearless,
free of conceit and free of remorse.

The thorn of existence has been pulled out;
this is the final body.

This is the supreme among those who have reached the end —

the unsurpassed station of peace,
where all signs are exhausted,
the deathless station of liberation and release.

Formations of like and unlike arising
have been thoroughly abandoned by the Sage.
Abiding in inner equipoise and joy,
he has split open and emerged from the hollow of the egg.

The Dharma's generosity surpasses all generosity.
The joy of Dharma surpasses all joy.
The strength of patience surpasses all strength.
The happiness of craving's exhaustion surpasses all happiness.

This is the twenty-sixth chapter of the Nirvāṇa section.

The faults of others, apart from one's own,
are like chaff that one scatters away —
the faults of others are easy to see,
while one's own faults are hard to perceive.
Like a cheat skillfully hiding his cheating,
one conceals one's own faults,
yet gazes at the faults of others
with a perception of perpetual haughtiness —
one who lives this way sees the Dharma not at all,
while conduct going astray increases to the left.
Arrogant, seizing for oneself, like a crow
engaged in impure deeds,
living utterly in affliction,
shameless and finding livelihood easy —
while one who ever seeks what is pure,
who is restrained and does not overstep the Sage's rule,
who lives a clean life in the view of right living —
the livelihood of one who knows shame is hard.

In this world grown dark,
few are those endowed with special insight.
Like a bird escaped from a snare,
only a few find joy in the higher realms.
Children, bound by the body,

are encircled by the ring of darkness.
Those who cling to the world's wealth
look upon others' belongings as their own;
thinking, "I have drawn these people out" and "others have done this,"
seeing what is not true as true —
one who holds such a view sees nothing at all.
Even if examined by others, it is not seen,
nor will the thorn be perceived.

Those who previously saw the thorns that arise
from the craving to which beings cling to objects —
they do not hold the thought "I have done this,"
nor do they hold the thought "another has done this."

These beings, full of pride,
attached to pride and bound by pride,
holding views that give rise to dispute —
they will not turn back from cyclic existence.

Both what has been attained
and what is to be attained
are polluted by the dust of corruption,
leading the afflicted one on, training him further.

Whoever makes moral discipline, training, vows, the holy life, austerity, and
close residence the very essence of his practice — that person stands
unambiguously on one side. Whoever sees in this way and claims, "This is
purity" — that is truly purity.

The practice of those who say "Desire is meritorious, desire is to be enjoyed,
desire is without fault" — and who thereby cause others to fall into excessive
desire — that too is one extreme. These two extremes multiply the charnel
ground; by means of them, the charnel ground is multiplied.

Some who do not see these two extremes become attached to one, and others
rush headlong into the other; those who become increasingly attached and
who rush increasingly into them are seen by one who possesses the eye.
Those who, upon seeing these two extremes, neither become attached nor
rush into them, and who neither increasingly attach to nor increasingly rush
into them — they too are seen by one who possesses the eye. When they
neither act in those ways nor think in those ways, what cannot be imputed as

a path for them is this: "This is the end of suffering."

Just as one sees a water bubble,
just as one sees a mirage,
so one who looks upon the world in this way
will not be seen by the King of Death.

Just as one sees a water bubble,
just as one sees a mirage,
so one who looks upon the body in this way
will not be seen by the King of Death.

That to which the childish are passionately attached —
the wise will not be attached to that.
Like the chariot of a king displayed in splendor,
look upon this body always in this way.

That by which the childish are bewildered —
the wise are not bewildered by that.
Like the chariot of a king displayed in splendor,
look upon this body always in this way.

Where the childish have come to ruin,
like an old ox that has fallen into the mud,
like the chariot of a king displayed in splendor,
look upon this body always in this way.

Subject to decay like a sick person,
like an open wound,
never remaining stable —
look upon this body always in this way.

Like a sick person subject to decay,
never remaining stable,
adorned with jeweled earrings and hooped ornaments —
look upon this body adorned in this way.

With hair arranged in eight braids
and eyes painted with collyrium,
the childish are greatly bewildered thereby,
yet they do not seek what lies beyond.

With eyes freshly drawn in collyrium,
and a body full of pus adorned with ornaments,

the childish are greatly bewildered thereby,
yet they do not seek what lies beyond.

With the body anointed with sweet fragrance
and feet rubbed with red lac,
the childish are greatly bewildered thereby,
yet they do not seek what lies beyond.

Whoever is fully caught up in and entangled by desire,
not seeing the faults of that entanglement,
that person who is attached and bound to desire
will not cross the wide and boundless river.

The highest and the lowest of the detached, all of them,
looking upon this as neither self nor mine —
thus liberated, they will cross the river
that was not crossed before, and there will be no more becoming.

Whoever has abandoned the grove yet is without a grove,
who has left the forest yet runs back into the forest —
the one who leads from freedom back into bondage —
look upon this person, come and see!

Look upon the chariot with well-matched spokes,
the limbs pleasingly arrayed, robed in white,
that faultless one journeying on —
cut the bonds of attachment.

People frightened by fear
mostly go for refuge to mountains and forests,
to pleasure groves, to sacred sites,
and to sacred trees.

That refuge is not the foremost refuge;
that refuge is not the supreme.

By going to that refuge,
one is not freed from all suffering.

Whoever goes for refuge to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha,
and sees with wisdom the Four Noble Truths —
suffering, the origin of all suffering,
the genuine passing beyond suffering,

and the noble eightfold path that leads to the bliss of nirvāṇa —
that is the supreme refuge,
that is the excellent refuge.
By going to that refuge,
one is freed from all suffering.

What is seen is seen, and through seeing, what is unseen is seen.
What is unseen cannot be seen by seeing alone; the object of sight is not
beheld.

Ordinary seeing and special insight are said to be distinct as separate things,
yet day and night they never abide together.

By seeing the similar, one does not truly see.

For if one sees, the similar is not seen.

By this act of seeing, the similar is not seen,
and one who sees the similar has no true seeing.

What is it that a person has not seen when they see the similar?

And what must one see for the similar not to be seen?

Just as in this world there is the seeing of the similar,
when that is absent, there is no seeing of the similar at all.

When suffering is not seen by this one,
then at that time the view of a self arises.

In precisely the way that suffering is understood,
by that very understanding, the view of a self such as this is no longer seen.

Because individual birth veils one's perception,
the suffering of formations is not seen.

Therefore in this world the similar is seen,
and without that condition, the similar is not seen.

This is the twenty-seventh chapter, the chapter on seeing.

Commit no evil whatsoever.

Accomplish virtue in its fullness.

Thoroughly tame your own mind.

This is the teaching of the buddhas.

Through generosity, merit grows abundantly.

Through good self-restraint, one does not make enemies.

One who is endowed with virtue abandons evil.

Through the exhaustion of afflictions, one passes beyond sorrow.

Whether one lives together with the wise, with spirits, or with common folk,
or dwells alone — no matter which —
just as a swan drinks milk from water,
the wise thoroughly abandon those who are evil.

One who sees the faults of the world
and sees the Dharma that leads to cessation:
a noble one does not delight in evil,
and one who is evil does not delight in virtue.

One who knows the taste of proper peace
and knows the taste of true seclusion —
free from the plague of sin, free from evil —
drinks the taste of delight in the Dharma.

With no defilement in the mind,
with the mind unbroken by bondage,
having thoroughly abandoned both virtue and evil,
there is no fear from the lower realms.

One should associate with the kind of person
who steers away from wrong, who speaks well,
who points out faults,
and who, as a wise one, speaks words that cut through error.

If one associates with such persons,
one will not fall into evil but will turn toward the good.
Peaceful and perfectly at peace,
speaking slowly and without conceit,
such a person shakes away evil qualities
as the wind shakes the leaves of a tree.

One who is pure, free from affliction,
free from hostility, yet who shows anger toward a person —
evil turns back upon that fool
as dust thrown against the wind.

One who does good acquires virtue;
one who does evil acquires evil.
Whatever a person has done,
that very thing one will see for oneself.
If I have committed evil,

that very self is entirely defiled.

If I have not committed evil,

that very self is utterly pure.

One person cannot act out the conduct of another;

purity and impurity are each one's own.

Whatever evil one has done and accumulated by oneself,

by that, one utterly destroys one's own wellbeing and makes it manifest —

as a vajra pierces a jewel.

Just as a person with sight navigates difficult and narrow paths,

so the wise in this living world

should thoroughly abandon evil.

Just as a great merchant travels with few companions,

and a trader takes a dangerous road,

and one who wishes to live avoids what is like poison —

so the wise should thoroughly abandon the evildoer.

If the palm of the hand has no wound,

one may hold poison in that hand,

for poison does not enter where there is no wound.

Likewise, no evil comes to one who has not committed it.

Actions that harm oneself and actions that are wrong

are easy to do.

But whatever is beneficial and brings happiness —

that is most difficult to do.

For a noble one, doing good is easy;

for a noble one, doing evil is difficult.

For a base person, doing evil is easy;

for a noble one, doing evil is difficult.

As long as evil has not ripened,

the fool thinks it sweet.

But when that evil has ripened,

then one feels it as something burning.

As long as evil has not ripened,

the evildoer regards it as acceptable.

But when that evil has ripened —

then one sees it as something evil.

As long as what is good has not ripened,
one regards what is good as something evil.
But when what is good has ripened,
then one sees it as good.

Because evil brings suffering in its wake,
one should take no delight in it.
Even if one has done evil a hundred times,
one should never do it again and again.
Because merit brings happiness in its wake,
one should take delight in that very thing.
And if one has done a meritorious deed,
one should do it again and again.

Since the mind takes keen pleasure in evil
yet performs merit only sluggishly,
turn the mind away from evil
and perform merit with all eagerness and speed.

Even a small evil deed
brings great ruin in the next world,
causes tremendous devastation,
like poison that has entered the stomach.

Even a small meritorious deed
leads to happiness in the next world
and brings about great and significant results,
like seeds that yield an abundant harvest.

One who punishes the blameless without cause,
who harbors intense hatred toward one who has done no wrong,
will swiftly come to meet one or another of ten misfortunes:
unbearable pain,
or bodily laceration,
or burning painful sensation,
or mental disturbance;
separation from dear ones,
or the exhaustion of wealth,
or harm brought by the king,
or intolerable ill repute;

or one's home will surely be consumed by great fire.
And when the body dissolves in bewildered folly,
the tenth — rebirth in an evil destiny.

Do not be at ease on account of having done evil.
Though you have put it far away and at a great distance, do not be at ease.
Even if you have made yourself solitary, do not be at ease.
Because its karmic maturation exists, be not at ease.

On account of having done merit, be at ease.
Though you have put it far away and at a great distance, be at ease.
Even if you have made yourself solitary, be at ease.
Because its karmic maturation exists, be at ease.

One who has done evil grieves.
One who has put it far away and at a great distance grieves.
One who has made oneself solitary grieves.
Because its karmic maturation exists, one grieves.
Seeing oneself possessed of dark karma,
one grieves here and grieves hereafter.
One who has done evil grieves in both places,
and that one grieves and grieves most deeply.

One who has done merit rejoices.
One who has put it far away and at a great distance rejoices.
One who has made oneself solitary rejoices.
Because its karmic maturation exists, one rejoices.
Seeing oneself possessed of pure karma,
one rejoices here and rejoices hereafter.
One who has done merit rejoices in both places,
and that one rejoices and rejoices most deeply.

One who has done evil is tormented.
One who has put it far away and at a great distance is tormented.
One who has made oneself solitary is tormented.
Because its karmic maturation exists, one is tormented.
Seeing oneself possessed of dark karma,
one is tormented here and tormented hereafter.
One who has done evil is tormented in both places,
and that one is tormented and tormented most deeply.

One who has done merit rejoices.

One who has put it far away and at a great distance rejoices.

One who has made oneself solitary rejoices.

Because its karmic maturation exists, one rejoices.

Seeing oneself possessed of white karma,

one rejoices here and rejoices hereafter.

One who has done merit rejoices in both places,

and that one rejoices and rejoices most deeply.

A person who has done evil and done no merit,

who has strayed from the Dharma and obtained what is not Dharma —

that one laden with evil karma trembles at death,

like a wretched boat breaking apart in a great flood.

One who has done merit and done no evil,

who has practiced the Dharma as the noble ones of old have done —

I, though I grow old, have no fear of death.

One crosses to the other shore, as if by a sturdy boat.

This is the twenty-eighth chapter on evil.

So long as the sun has not yet risen,

fireflies appear to give light.

But when the sun has risen,

that light vanishes and all becomes blue sky.

So long as the Tathāgata has not yet risen,

those who speculate and argue appear to shine.

But when the perfectly awakened buddha of the world has risen,

the argumentative ones and the hearers alike no longer appear.

One who mentally grasps what is not dear as dear,

and conceives of what is dear as not dear —

that one, whose domain is perverted conceptualization,

will not attain what is truly dear.

One who perceives what is not dear as not dear,

and perceives what is dear as dear —

that one, whose domain is correct conceptualization,

will attain what is truly dear.

Those here who are bound by attachment to seeing and hearing,

whose bonds, both old and new, continue to grow —

they run through saṃsāra, going and remaining,
like a moth falling into flame.

Whatever doubts are held here or expected to arise elsewhere,
and all the various uncertainties that exist in this life —
by striving in the holy life and through earnest effort,
and by sustained reflection, one fully abandons them all.

One who, while still full of defilements,
puts on the ochre robe —
if that one lacks self-restraint and equanimity,
that one is unworthy of wearing the ochre robe.

But one who has abandoned the defilements,
is well-established and composed in moral discipline,
and is endowed with self-restraint and equanimity —
that one is truly worthy of wearing the ochre robe.

A person possessed of deceit, fraud, and cunning,
whether endowed with fine complexion and form,
or merely with eloquent speech —
does not thereby become an excellent man.

But one who has cut away those three things
as one cuts the crown from a palm tree,
and who, being wise, has removed all faults —
that one may rightly be called an excellent man.

In this world, one who is not well restrained within
goes about for the most part displaying the marks of good restraint.
Without careful examination, people
should not trust what they see from appearances alone on a few occasions.

Like a mismatched goat's jaw, it fits nothing;
like iron half-covered with gold —
vicious within, while wearing a noble appearance without,
such a one wanders through this world with a retinue.

One who fills the belly and sleeps in sloth,
who rolls from side to side day and night,
is like a great fat pig fattened on slop,
entering again and again into the womb of blame.

A person who is always endowed with mindfulness
and always knows the right measure in food —
that one's suffering will become slight,
and digesting slowly, their life too will be long.

One who does not restrain the sense faculties,
who does not know the measure in food,
who is slack in mindfulness and given to laziness,
and who lives while regarding the body as clean —
that one is overcome by desires,
like a tree unsteady in the wind.

One who well restrains the sense faculties,
who knows the measure in food,
who is individually mindful and endowed with diligence,
and who dwells with the view of the body as impure —
that one is not overcome by desires,
as the wind does not shake a mountain.

Solitude is something worthy of delight.
Though ordinary people do not delight in it,
those who are free from desire delight in it —
it is not for those who seek sensual pleasures.

Whether it be a forest hermitage, a village,
a ravine, or an open plain —
whatever place a noble one inhabits,
that place is a pleasing one.

A holy person is visible from afar,
like a snow-clad Himalayan peak.
But an evil person, though near, does not appear,
like an arrow shot into darkness.

When a wise and purposeful person
keeps company with a holy being,
great benefit arises,
and one comes to individually realize profound wisdom.

Like a battle elephant struck by arrows
shot from a bow on the front line of combat,
one must endure the harsh words

spoken by the many people of corrupt conduct.

A person who troubles households,
who is without faith and ungrateful for what has been done,
who destroys opportunity and consumes what is vomited —
such a one is a holy person? No, indeed they are not.

One who has killed father and mother, and —

Two pure kings,
and the realm together with its retinue having been subdued —
people, it is said, become purified.

Those who have no clinging anywhere,
who know food completely,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and seclusion itself —
their going is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no clinging anywhere,
who know food completely,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and seclusion itself —
their trail is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no clinging anywhere,
who know food completely,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and constant meditative
concentration —
their going is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no clinging anywhere,
who know food completely,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and constant meditative
concentration —
their trail is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no clinging anywhere,
who know food completely,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and seclusion itself —

their going is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no clinging anywhere,
who know food completely,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and seclusion itself —
their trail is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no support at the far shore of the father,
who fully know the exhaustion of all defilements,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and seclusion itself —
their going is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no support at the far shore of the father,
who fully know the exhaustion of all defilements,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and seclusion itself —
their trail is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no support at the far shore of the father,
who fully know the exhaustion of all defilements,
whose domain is abandonment, the signless, and constant meditative
concentration —
their going is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no support at the far shore of the father,
who fully know the exhaustion of all defilements,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and constant meditative
concentration —
their trail is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no support at the far shore of the father,
who fully know the exhaustion of all defilements,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and constant meditative
concentration —
their going is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

Those who have no support at the far shore of the father,
who fully know the exhaustion of all defilements,
whose domain is emptiness, the signless, and constant meditative
concentration —
their trail is hard to trace,
like the track of a bird in the sky.

The common run of beings rushes along the near shore,
while those among people who make their way to the far shore
are few indeed.

Those who, by attending to the Dharma with a dharma-eye
upon the Dharma that has been well proclaimed,
are among those people who go beyond
the great and difficult ocean of birth and death.

The protector is utterly liberated,
free from the sorrow of what has passed,
having abandoned every bond —
there will be no anguish for such a one.

Having crossed the fearsome road,
having altogether left behind the precipice,
having been freed from bondage and every knot,
all the poisons of attachment are destroyed.

There is no mire of the swamp of desire,
no harm of the sort that aversion brings,
no net of the kind that delusion weaves,
no river of the current of craving.

Like a track in the sky,
there is no ascetic among the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas).
Children delight in conceptual elaboration,
but the Tathāgata is without such elaboration —
it is in order to lead children by means of engagement that —

The wise one overcomes all bonds.
The wise one overcomes whatever bonds
gods and humans may have —
and because one is free from all such bonds,
one is liberated from every suffering.

From bonds, existence arises;
without bonds, existence is exhausted.
Know these two paths —
the path of existence and the path beyond existence —
and, in order to utterly cross over from bondage,
let the wise one train in that.

One who has acted wrongly is tormented,
and is tormented again in the lower destinies that follow.
One who has acted rightly rejoices,
and rejoices again in the higher destinies that follow.
Since the one who acts thus will be tormented hereafter,
of the two it is better not to act wrongly.
What does not cause torment is what should be done —
and for that, acting rightly is appropriate.

From the mingling of the wise and the childish,
what has not been said will not be understood,
so speak of the level of peace,
and through speaking it will be understood.
Well-spoken words are the victory banner of the sages;
since the victory banner of the sages is the Dharma,
let the Dharma be illumined by teaching,
and raise the victory banner of the sages.

If one does not speak, people find fault;
if one speaks much, they find fault;
if one speaks little, they find fault —
in the world there is none who is not criticized.
A person who is only to be blamed
and a person who is only to be praised
do not exist at present,
have not come to be, and will not come to be.

Those in whom there is no conceptual elaboration in dwelling,
those who have utterly turned back from the torment of all binding
engagements —
though the Sage, free from craving, might serve as their cause,
the world together with its gods does not understand them.

Those who praise others according to however much they have realized,
in whom faith, moral discipline, and discernment
have not been lacking in their benefit to the mind —
such knowing ones are not worthy of blame by anyone.
They are like the gold ornaments of Jambudvīpa.

Just as mountains and cliffs
are not shaken by the wind,
so too the wise are not disturbed
by praise or blame.

On what stretch of ground is there no grass,
where could there be leaves and small shoots?
The steadfast one who is freed from bondage —
how could such a one ever be worthy of blame by anyone?

One who does not fall away from victory,
in whom there is not the least worldly defeat,
whose domain as a buddha is boundless —
by what path, where there is nothing to travel, could such a one be led?

One who does not fall away from victory,
in whom there is not the least worldly defeat,
whose power as a buddha is boundless —
by what path, where there is nothing to travel, could such a one be led?

For one whom no existence that might lead astray
bears anything resembling the craving for objects,
whose domain as a buddha is boundless —
by what path, where there is nothing to travel, could such a one be led?

For one whom no existence that might lead astray
bears anything resembling the craving for objects,
whose power as a buddha is boundless —
by what path, where there is nothing to travel, could such a one be led?

One who has fully dispelled conceptual thought
and is without conceptual thought regarding anything within,
who has gone beyond all binding engagement, form, and perception,
who is free from the four meditative absorptions (dhyānas) and is without
arising,
who is free from what is before and free from what comes after,

who is free from the middle and has gone beyond existence,
whose mind is liberated from every aspect —
such a one will not be led on again to birth, aging, or what follows.

This is the twenty-ninth cluster of verses.

From victory, enmity arises,
and the one who is defeated attains suffering.
If both victory and defeat are abandoned,
one attains the happiness of peace.

One who wishes for one's own happiness
by generating suffering in others
will not be parted from enemies,
and will not be freed from suffering.

One who, wishing for happiness, harms beings
and cuts them down with punishment —
that one who desires one's own happiness
will not attain happiness hereafter.

Those who desire happiness,
who do not harm beings,
who do not cut them down with punishment, and who desire happiness —
they will attain happiness hereafter.

One should practise the Dharma well
and not practise wrongly.
In this world and in the next,
through practising the Dharma one attains happiness.

Through practising the Dharma well, happiness is produced —
one who practises the Dharma is protected by the Dharma.
One who practises the Dharma does not go to the lower realms.
Such is the benefit of practising the Dharma well.

Like a great, broad canopy sheltering from the summer heat,
one who practises the Dharma is protected by the Dharma.
One who practises the Dharma does not go to the lower realms.
Such is the benefit of practising the Dharma well.

If a heedless person pursues what is contrary to the Dharma,
that one, in whatever existence, goes to the lower realms.
Like one here who is seized by a black snake at the waist,
those who engage in what is contrary to the Dharma will come to ruin.

The karmic ripening of the Dharma and of what is contrary to the Dharma
will not be the same.

What is contrary to the Dharma leads one to hell;
the Dharma brings one to a happy existence.

At the time of giving and at the time of battle,
since these are alike in being upheld by what is at stake,
giving and going to battle are said to be comparable.
Yet those two qualities are not supported by inferior persons.

Even one who is supremely and well prepared
can be defeated by one who is poorly prepared but nimble, just as in battle.
Similarly, if one gives even a small amount with genuine faith,
through that one will find happiness hereafter.

Here, more than a warrior who repels enemies a hundredfold,
who overwhelms the foe of miserliness and vanquishes it —
one who gives with a mind free from attachment:
that one, I declare, is the most courageous of all.

The ripening of merit is happiness;
aspiration fully accomplished brings abundance.
Swiftly one will attain the peace supreme,
the passing beyond sorrow, nirvāṇa.

For those who make merit,
harm arising from others,
and obstruction by the hosts of gods and māras —
none of these can impede them.

If, in order to exhaust suffering,
one makes effort with a noble and wisdom-endowed mind that relinquishes,
through that effort one will come to be touched
by insight.

The mind, thoroughly cleansed,
rejoices in the Dharma and attains happiness.
The wise ever rejoice

in the teachings proclaimed by the noble ones.

Those who delight in meditative concentration of mind,
those who delight in the unborn,
who attend to the four foundations of mindfulness,
the seven factors of awakening,
the four bases of miraculous power,
and the noble eightfold path —
they wear the robe of the Dharma
and eat their alms-food in ease.

They walk at ease in mountains and forests,
and they, having attained happiness,
pass beyond sorrow in the Dharma seen here and now.

Having left behind all enmity and fear,
having crossed beyond the worldly realm of existence —
to hear the Dharma, to see it,
and to delight in solitude: this is happiness.

Not harming the living beings and creatures of the world,
and truly holding to non-violence in one's vow: this is happiness.

To have fully transcended desires,
to be free from attachment to the world: this is happiness.

To have tamed the pride that says "I" and "mine": this is supreme happiness.

To have moral discipline in old age: this is happiness.

To rest firmly in faith: this is happiness.

To delight in meaningful speech: this is happiness.

Not to commit evil: this is happiness.

In the world, to honor one's mother: this is happiness.

Likewise, to honor one's father: this is happiness.

In the world, to honor the ascetics (śramaṇas): this is happiness.

Likewise, to honor the brahmins: this is happiness.

For buddhas to appear: this is happiness.

Likewise, for the Dharma to be taught: this is happiness.

For the Saṅgha to be in harmony: this is happiness.

The austerity of those in harmony: this is happiness.

To see one who is endowed with moral discipline: this is happiness.

To see one of great learning: this is happiness.

To see arhats who have been fully liberated from renewed existence: this is happiness.

A river pleasant to enter, pleasant in its banks, is happiness.

A person who is victorious through the Dharma: this is happiness.

One who has attained wisdom: this is happiness.

The exhaustion of pride and conceit: this is happiness.

To see the noble ones: this is happiness.

To keep company with the holy ones: this is happiness.

If one does not encounter the childish and foolish,
one will be ever and truly happy.

To keep company with the childish, who in every way resemble enemies,
is suffering;

one who associates with the foolish and childish
will long repent it afterward.

A person who truly knows is rare;
such a one does not arise everywhere.

To keep company with the steadfast is happiness, like meeting with one's own
kin.

Wherever a steadfast one is born,
that family attains happiness through him.

Brahmins (brahmins) who have passed beyond sorrow
enter into happiness in every respect.

One who is not tainted by desire,
who is fully liberated and without defilement,
who has cut through every craving,
who has cleared the fever from the heart,
who has attained peace of mind —
such a one enters into a state of nearness, of peace and happiness.

One who longs for expansive happiness
and wishes to abandon lesser happiness:
if, through steadfastness, one forsakes the lesser happiness,
then the greater happiness is seen clearly.

Whatever worldly happiness there is in desire,
whatever happiness there is in the realm of the gods —
even a sixteenth part of these
does not approach the happiness of the exhaustion of craving.

Because one has taken up suffering by taking up a burden,
if one sets down the burden, happiness arises.
If one decisively lays aside the heavy burden,
one will not take up another afterward.

In order to exhaust every binding connection,
abandon craving entirely.
If all the aggregates are known through and through,
there will be no going on to a further existence.

It is happiness to have companions when the aim is being purified.
It is happiness to touch merit when living beings are fully encountered.
It is happiness to be content with even a little, and thereby to be at ease.
It is happiness when all suffering is surely extinguished.

Here, a fire that is blazing,
struck with an iron hammer,
gradually comes to rest —
and where it has gone, no one knows.

Crossing the mire and morass of desire,
reaching the unshakeable state,
and being well and thoroughly liberated —
such beings' destination cannot be designated.

One who has no inner turmoil,
one who has turned away from craving and from the absence of craving alike
—
such ones are fearless, happy, and free of sorrow.
Even the gods look upon them and find them beyond thought.

Here, those who have heard much Dharma
and who are without any remaining grasping — how happy are they!
Look at those who are intensely attached to person after person, body after
body,
and who have lost even the little they possessed.

Here, those who have heard much Dharma
and who are without any remaining clinging — how happy are they!
Look at those who are intensely attached to person after person, body after
body,
and who have lost even the little they possessed.

One who has realized whatever virtues there are yet possesses nothing — how
happy!
Look at those who are intensely attached to person after person, mind after
mind,
and who have lost even the little they possessed.

One who has realized whatever virtues there are yet possesses nothing — how
happy!
Look at those who are intensely attached to person after person, body after
body,
and who have lost even the little they possessed.

Everything subject to another's power is suffering.
Everything where one's own power holds is happiness.
What is very difficult to relinquish is bondage;
through being shared in common, it is simply lost.

Among people caught in attachment,
to dwell free of attachment —
to be unattached in the midst of the attached:
how supremely happy is that life!

Among people struck down by illness,
to dwell free of illness —
to be without sickness in the midst of the sick:
how supremely happy is that life!

Among people given to harming,
to dwell free of harm —
to be without harm in the midst of the harmful:
how supremely happy is that life!

Among people with malicious intent,
to dwell free of malice —
to be without ill will among those who bear it:
how supremely happy is that life!

Among people full of resentment,
to dwell free of resentment —
to be without grudge in the midst of the resentful:
how supremely happy is that life!

Though all of Mithilā were burned to the ground,
nothing of mine is scorched.
Since nothing of mine is there to lose,
how supremely happy is that life!

Though I have nothing at all,
I feed on joy.
Like the gods of luminosity,
how supremely happy is that life!

Not relying upon the transitory collection,
I have nothing of my own —
yet I feed on joy:
how supremely happy is that life!

Through the condition of clinging, contact and touch arise;
without clinging, there is no contact and no touch.
The pleasure and pain produced by self and other —
whether in a hermitage or in a town, contact will not arise.
In this world, pleasure and suffering
do not make the noble person high or low,
and the steadfast are not swept away by the causes of desire —
the noble person walks onward everywhere.

This concludes the thirtieth chapter, the chapter on happiness.

The Chapter of Deliberate Utterances. The fourth fascicle, being the last.

Hard to hold, light in weight,
alighting wherever it wishes to go —
the taming of the mind is excellent indeed;
a tamed mind brings happiness.

When abandoning the strongholds of Māra,
drawn out from its watery dwelling,
my mind trembles utterly,
like a fish thrown upon dry land.

Like rays streaming from the sun,
my mind scatters in all directions.
The wise person, having decisively restrained it,
holds it like an elephant-hook holds a great elephant.

That which acts in me without purpose,
that which is hollow, without essence —
in order to tame it always,
I speak to that mind.

This mind, just as it formerly desired,
ranging and wandering in pursuit of pleasures —
it must be caught by acting properly,
as a man with an elephant-hook catches a maddened elephant.

O builder of the house! You shall not build again.
Your many cycles of rebirth, full of suffering —
all of those are now extracted.
From this moment forth you shall build no more.
Seeing you, O builder of the house,
the great ridge-pole of the house is broken,
all the rafters are shattered —
the mind, separated from formations,
finds its exhaustion right here.

The mind is restless and deceptive,
ranging far and hard to turn back.
Let it be steadied by one who is intent,
as a fletcher straightens an arrow with fire.

That which dwells within the bodyless cave,
roaming alone and ranging far —
whoever tames that mind
will be freed from great fear.

The mind with wrong aspiration
becomes the cause of suffering for oneself —
and even a resentful enemy towards one who is hated
could not do to them what that mind does.

The mind with right aspiration
becomes the cause of happiness for oneself —

and even a father and mother,
or any other kin,
could not do for one what that mind does.

Just as rain pours through a badly thatched roof,
so attachment wholly overwhelms the uncultivated mind.
Just as rain does not penetrate a well-thatched roof,
so attachment cannot overwhelm the well-cultivated mind.

Just as rain pours through a badly thatched roof,
so aversion wholly overwhelms the uncultivated mind.
Just as rain does not penetrate a well-thatched roof,
so aversion cannot overwhelm the well-cultivated mind.

Just as rain pours through a badly thatched roof,
so delusion wholly overwhelms the uncultivated mind.
Just as rain does not penetrate a well-thatched roof,
so delusion cannot overwhelm the well-cultivated mind.

Just as rain pours through a badly thatched roof,
so pride wholly overwhelms the uncultivated mind.
Just as rain does not penetrate a well-thatched roof,
so pride cannot overwhelm the well-cultivated mind.

Just as rain pours through a badly thatched roof,
so clinging wholly overwhelms the uncultivated mind.
Just as rain does not penetrate a well-thatched roof,
so clinging cannot overwhelm the well-cultivated mind.

Just as rain pours through a badly thatched roof,
so craving wholly overwhelms the uncultivated mind.
Just as rain does not penetrate a well-thatched roof,
so craving cannot overwhelm the well-cultivated mind.

Mind goes before all things;
mind is swift, mind is chief.
If with a deeply corrupt mind
one speaks or acts,
suffering follows that one
as the wheel follows the foot of the ox.

Mind goes before all things;
mind is swift, mind is chief.
If with a deeply clear and pure mind
one speaks or acts,
happiness follows that one
as a shadow that never departs.

One who grasps hard at dispute,
whose mind is afflicted,
who goes about seeking an opening —
such a one does not understand good teaching well.

Those whose minds are filled with hatred, or agitation,
or who are without faith,
are unable to know the entire sacred Dharma
taught by the perfectly awakened buddha.

One who has tamed heedlessness of mind
and thoroughly subdued anger,
and has here utterly abandoned malicious intent —
that one understands well-spoken teaching.

Without steadiness of mind
one does not come to know the sacred Dharma.
When faith is unstable and wavering,
wisdom cannot be fully perfected.

Resting in conceptual elaboration, dependent on it,
the stream of thirty-six wrong views
flows and rushes forth
from the stream of mind.

One whose faculties are governed by a rejoicing mind,
whose following of mind is feeble —
that person's fame fades while fruits accumulate for others,
like birds upon a laden tree.

O mind, do not rejoice in ruin and delight in desire!
Dwell in diligence and heedfulness.
You who were scorched in hell through heedlessness
and burned by iron balls — do not weep now!

One who sits when it is time to rise,
who in the vigor of youth makes no effort but stays at home,
and who grows lazy when aspiration should be complete —
such a person's wisdom will never discern the path.

Engaging in subtle conceptual thought about trifles,
one scatters and agitates the inner-dwelling mind.
If one does not recognize those mental constructs,
the bewildered mind runs on again and again.

But one who is endowed with mindfulness and discernment,
who strives with diligence and is skilled in conceptual analysis —
knowing the agitation of the inner-dwelling mind,
one relinquishes all of it entirely with intelligence.

Having understood this body to be like a clay pot,
and having fortified the mind as one fortifies a city,
one must battle māra with the weapon of wisdom,
and having conquered, guard without any fixed abode.

Having understood these worlds to be like a clay pot,
and knowing phenomena likewise to be like a mirage,
one must battle māra with the weapon of wisdom,
and having conquered, guard without any fixed abode.

Having understood this body to be like foam,
and having fortified the mind as one fortifies a city,
one must battle māra with the weapon of wisdom,
and having conquered, guard without any fixed abode.

Having understood these worlds likewise to be like foam,
and having fortified the mind as one fortifies a city,
one must battle māra with the weapon of wisdom,
and having conquered, guard without any fixed abode.

One who has cultivated well in mind
the seven limbs of awakening,
who takes no delight in clinging
and has utterly abandoned grasping,
who has eliminated the defilements and their faults —
such a one has passed beyond sorrow in this world.

One who guards one's own mind
as carefully as the tip of a yak's tail,
and who is endowed with loving care toward all beings —
that one's happiness shall never diminish.

Because the mind of the great elephant,
the tusked bull elephant with fine tusks,
is equal to itself alone,
therefore it rejoices alone in the forest.

One whose mind is free of harm,
who has loving care toward all beings
and extends loving-kindness to all beings —
toward such a one, resentment never arises.

One whose mind is free of harm,
who has loving care toward all beings
and extends loving-kindness to all living creatures —
toward such a one, resentment never arises.

One whose mind is free of harm,
who has loving care toward beings
and extends loving-kindness to all sentient beings —
toward such a one, resentment shall never arise.

To all friends and companions,
and to all beings, having loving care
and having cultivated the mind of loving-kindness —
happiness shall increase greatly.

If someone harbors no aversion toward any living creature
and cultivates loving-kindness, that itself is virtue.
If one tenderly extends the mind toward all sentient beings,
a great abundance of merit shall be accomplished by the noble one.

One who meditates on virtuous phenomena
with a joyful mind
and a spirit free of despondency
shall attain accomplishment and happiness.

Freed through correct understanding,
with weariness fully quieted,
that one's mind becomes still,

and the actions of body and speech become still as well.

Just as, with a one-pointed mind,
one sees phenomena clearly and well,
so not even the five-branched lute
brings delight in that same way.

Those whose mind rejoices in meditative absorption
do not play with sensual pleasures.
One who is free from even a little burning anguish
shall rest at ease as a protector.

Those whose mind rejoices in meditative absorption
do not play with sensual pleasures.
One who is free from even a little burning anguish —
how wonderful, O Sage, shall be the joy!

One whose mind remains utterly unmoved, like a rock,
unattached in the places of attachment,
undisturbed in the places of anger —
how could such a mind ever come to know suffering?

Do not slander, do not harm.
Restrain yourself by the rules of individual liberation.
Know moderation in food.
Dwell in solitude far from the crowd.
And apply yourself to yoga of the higher mind.
This is the teaching of the Buddha.

Skilled in observing the signs of mind,
one who has found the taste of genuine solitude,
who maintains the vigor of a properly composed mind,
enjoys a happiness free of all clinging.

One who is devoted in mind to solitude, who delights in solitude and dwells in
solitude,
who constantly guards one's own conduct of body,
speech, and mind —
that one abandons sorrow and shall not come to know suffering.

Minds left unguarded,
overcome by wrong views,

vanquished by sleep and torpor —
these fall under the power of Māra.

Therefore, guard the mind,
advance it through correct view,
let it range in right thought,
and understand the right arising and passing away.

The monk who overcomes sleep and torpor
attains the exhaustion of suffering.

Heedfully guarding the mind
and taming the mind is pleasant, a proper restraint.
Those among beings who are deceived by mind
are cast straight down into the hells.

Heedfully guarding the mind
and taming the mind is pleasant, a proper restraint.
Those among beings who are deceived by mind
are cast straight into the animal realm.

Heedfully guarding the mind
and taming the mind is pleasant, a proper restraint.
Those among beings who are deceived by mind
are cast straight into the realm of hungry ghosts.

Heedfully guarding the mind
and taming the mind is pleasant, a proper restraint.
Those among beings who guard the mind
rejoice exclusively among humans.

Heedfully guarding the mind
and taming the mind is pleasant, a proper restraint.
Those among beings who guard the mind
rejoice exclusively in the higher realms.

Heedfully guarding the mind
and taming the mind is pleasant, a proper restraint.
Those among beings who guard the mind
attain exclusively nirvāṇa.

This is the thirty-first chapter of the mind.

A monk who goes on alms-round for himself alone,
satisfying only himself and nourishing no others,
yet who is ever at peace, ever endowed with mindfulness —
in that protector the gods take delight.

A monk who goes on alms-round for himself alone,
satisfying only himself and nourishing no others —
it is in that protector that the gods take delight,
not in those who seek honor, wealth, and renown.

A monk who has abandoned all desires,
who has swept away the dust that stood before him,
who relies upon the teaching of selflessness (anātman) —
such a one has no need to instruct others.

Though an unrestrained person speaks wounding words,
though harsh and unbearable speech falls upon the ear,
the monk who is free of aversion — what does any of it matter to him?
He is like a great elephant pierced by arrows on the battlefield.

Though an unrestrained person speaks wounding words,
though harsh and unbearable speech falls upon the ear,
the monk whose mind is well composed — what does any of it matter to him?
He is like a great elephant pierced by arrows on the battlefield.

He does not live by craft, yet he delights in the field of practice.
With faculties tamed and liberated from all things,
unattached to home, free of heedlessness and craving —
one who lives in this solitary way: that is a monk.

One should dwell in pure and equal livelihood, without excess.
One should rely upon compatible companions.
One should know how to share things among one another,
and be skilled in the conduct and ritual of one's domain.

Hands well restrained and feet well restrained,
words well restrained and faculties well restrained,
delighting in entering inward into solitary meditative equipoise —
one who is thus content: this, it is said, is a monk.

A monk who delights in the Dharma,
who finds joy in the Dharma, who contemplates the Dharma,
who continuously recollects the Dharma —

will never decline from the Dharma.

A monk who enters an empty dwelling
and turns attention inward,
and who clearly sees phenomena as they are —
will come to possess the joy of the gods.

However clearly one understands arising and passing away
in the aggregates (skandhas),
to just that degree one attains
joy and contentment.

A monk endowed with great joy
will attain the exhaustion of suffering.
Just as a rocky mountain
is not stirred at all by the wind,
so a monk in whom attachment has been exhausted
is not stirred at all.

Just as a rocky mountain
is not stirred at all by the wind,
so a monk in whom aversion has been exhausted
is not stirred at all.

Just as a rocky mountain
is not stirred at all by the wind,
so a monk in whom delusion has been exhausted
is not stirred at all.

Just as a rocky mountain
is not stirred at all by the wind,
so a monk in whom pride has been exhausted
is not stirred at all.

Just as a rocky mountain
is not stirred at all by the wind,
so a monk in whom clinging has been exhausted
is not stirred at all.

Just as a rocky mountain
is not stirred at all by the wind,
so a monk in whom craving has been exhausted

is not stirred at all.

One who has no accumulation of anything whatsoever,
who has no sense of ownership,
who, even when things are absent, does not grieve —
that one is called a monk.

One might think: "Is anyone who merely begs from others
not thereby a monk?"

Or: "Is one who holds to the ways of a householder
not thereby a monk?"

One who has thoroughly abandoned both virtue and evil,
who lives a life of purity (brahmacarya),
who has forsaken all factions and so conducts themselves —
that one is called a monk.

A monk who abides in loving-kindness
and is deeply devoted to the teaching of the Buddha —
through that devotion, insatiable in contemplation,
will attain the peaceful station of nirvāṇa.

A monk who abides in loving-kindness
and is deeply devoted to the teaching of the Buddha —
through the stilling and cessation of formations,
will attain the peaceful station of nirvāṇa.

A monk who abides in loving-kindness
and is deeply devoted to the teaching of the Buddha —
will realize all compounded things as exhausted
and progressively come to know this directly.

A monk who abides in loving-kindness
and is deeply devoted to the teaching of the Buddha —
will draw himself out of lower rebirths,
like a great elephant from a swamp.

A monk who abides in loving-kindness —
and is deeply devoted to the teaching of the Buddha —
will shake off all evil phenomena,
as the wind shakes the leaves of a great tree.

A monk who abides in loving-kindness
and is deeply devoted to the teaching of the Buddha —
since nirvāṇa is near at hand,
there is no possibility of his falling away.

One whose mind is joyful, whose mentation is good,
who overcomes both pleasure and displeasure —
a monk possessed of such abundant joy
will attain the exhaustion of suffering.

One whose body is stilled, whose speech is stilled,
whose mind is stilled and well-settled in equipoise,
who has abandoned the world's entanglements —
such a monk, it is said, is fully at peace.

Without meditative absorption there is no wisdom,
and without wisdom there is no meditative absorption.
One who is possessed of both wisdom and meditative absorption —
that, it is said, is what it means to be a monk.

Therefore, into meditative absorption and wisdom
the wise should enter.

This, then, is the first task
of a monk who possesses wisdom.

One should know contentment and restrain the sense faculties,
and be restrained by the individual liberation vow.
One should also know the measure in food,
and dwell at the far end of a forest retreat.
One should practice yoga applied to the higher mind.
This is the teaching of the Buddha.

One in whom no wrong has been done
by body, speech, or mind —
that one is possessed of virtuous moral discipline,
a monk endowed with a sense of shame.

One who has well cultivated
the seven factors of the side of perfect awakening —
that one is possessed of virtuous qualities,
a monk in meditative equipoise, it is said.

One who here and now, in his own person,
thoroughly knows the exhaustion of suffering,
who is virtuous and possessed of wisdom —
that one, it is said, is a monk without outflows.

If the exhaustion of outflows has not been attained,
whether one is merely restrained in moral discipline and observances,
or one is greatly learned,
or one dwells in remote and solitary places,
or even if one has attained meditative absorption — yet rests
and cuts the warmth of effort —
such a one is not a monk.

These worlds, claiming self in the aggregates,
give rise to torment.

The bliss of perfect awakening
is to be actualized as the noble ones have taught.

Whatever and however one has been thinking,
accordingly one becomes otherwise.

This world, which becomes otherwise,
is attached to existence and delights in existence,
is deeply attached to existence and delights in existence,
is openly delighted in existence itself.

But what there is to delight in is suffering,
and what there is to be weary of is bliss.

Therefore, for the complete abandonment of existence,
the holy life is practiced here.

However many renunciants and brahmins there are
who say that through existence one renounces existence —
all of them, it should be said,
are not truly renouncing existence.

However many renunciants and brahmins there are
who say that through existence one renounces existence —
all of them, it should be said,
are not truly liberated from existence.

Suffering arises from the condition of clinging,
and from suffering, clinging arises.

When all clinging is entirely exhausted,

there is no further arising of suffering.

Whatever the many forms of existence there are when there is clinging to all of them — all of those are impermanent, suffering, and subject to change. If one sees them just as they are with virtuous wisdom, one will completely abandon craving for existence, and without existence, one will have no delight in it. Thus a monk who has gone beyond sorrow — the protector — will have no further clinging and no further becoming. One who has overpowered the māra, who has conquered in battle, who has passed entirely beyond all existence — such is what this is: the end of suffering.

A monk who has cut off objects of attachment,
who is at peace, whose mind is stilled —
will have no further becoming
and has completely abandoned the cycle of rebirth.

A monk who has cut off objects of attachment,
who is at peace, whose mind is stilled —
is freed from the bonds of the māra
and has completely abandoned the cycle of rebirth.

A monk who has cut off objects of attachment,
whose mind has become without outflows —
will have no further becoming
and has completely abandoned the cycle of rebirth.

A monk who has cut off objects of attachment,
whose mind has become without outflows —
is freed from the bonds of the māra
and has completely abandoned the cycle of rebirth.

A monk who has cut off objects of attachment
and who has torn out craving for existence —
will have no further becoming
and has completely abandoned the cycle of rebirth.

A monk who has cut off objects of attachment
and who has cut off craving for existence —
is freed from the bonds of the māra
and has completely abandoned the cycle of rebirth.

One who has crossed the mire and quicksand well,
who has trampled the thorns of the village,
and who has reached the exhaustion of attachment —
such a one, it is said, is a monk.

One who has crossed the mire and quicksand well,
who has trampled the thorns of the village,
and who has reached the exhaustion of aversion —
such a one, it is said, is a monk.

One who has crossed the mire and quicksand well,
who has trampled the thorns of the village,
and who has reached the exhaustion of delusion —
such a one, it is said, is a monk.

One who has crossed the mire and quicksand well,
who has trampled the thorns of the village,
and who has reached the exhaustion of conceit —
such a one, it is said, is a monk.

One who has crossed the mire and quicksand well,
who has trampled the thorns of the village,
and who has reached the exhaustion of clinging —
such a one, it is said, is a monk.

One who has crossed the mire and quicksand well,
who has trampled the thorns of the village,
and who has reached the exhaustion of craving —
such a one, it is said, is a monk.

One who does not abuse and does not kill,
who is restrained and has subdued the thorns of the village,
who abides like a mountain, unshaken and unattached,
unmoved by suffering and by pleasure — that one is a monk.

A monk who neither denigrates nor exaggerates,
who understands that all this world is false —
that one has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

As a medicine works against the venom that a serpent has released —
a monk who tames the uprising of attachment
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,

and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

As a medicine works against the venom that a serpent has released —
a monk who tames the uprising of aversion
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

As a medicine works against the venom that a serpent has released —
a monk who tames the uprising of delusion
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

As a medicine works against the venom that a serpent has released —
a monk who tames the uprising of conceit
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

As a medicine works against the venom that a serpent has released —
a monk who tames the uprising of clinging
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

As a medicine works against the venom that a serpent has released —
a monk who tames the uprising of anger
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

As a medicine works against the venom that a serpent has released —
a monk who tames the uprising of craving
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a great river against the frail reeds of a marsh —
a monk who uproots attachment without remainder
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a great river against the frail reeds of a marsh —
a monk who uproots aversion without remainder
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a great river against the frail reeds of a marsh —
a monk who uproots delusion without remainder
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a great river against the frail reeds of a marsh —
a monk who uproots pride without remainder
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a great river against the frail reeds of a marsh —
a monk who uproots attachment without remainder
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

Like a great river against the frail reeds of a marsh —
a monk who uproots craving without remainder
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

A monk who renounces all the qualities of desire
and clears away the fetters of sensual bondage
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

A monk who has abandoned all obscurations, is free of fault,
and has cut through the thorn of doubt
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

A monk who has removed all inner conceptual constructs
and is free of conceptual thought
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

A monk who has thoroughly pulled out the root
of non-virtue that causes affliction — leaving none —
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

A monk who has thoroughly pulled out the root
of non-virtue that is ridden with disease — leaving none —
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,

and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

A monk who has thoroughly pulled out the root
of non-virtue that contains latent tendencies — leaving none —
has gone to the far shore of the not-far-shore,
and abandons, like an old serpent shedding its worn skin.

A monk who possesses discipline — that is the monk.
Meditative concentration possessed of emptiness — that is meditation.
Whoever constantly practices — that is the yogin.
Whoever has passed beyond sorrow — that is bliss.

A monk speaks neither of pleasure nor of displeasure,
but dwells in solitary resting places at the forest's edge.
Such a one abides in heedfulness, and thoroughly extracts
the subtle tendrils of craving and attachment.

This is the thirty-second chapter of the Monks.

Whoever, though adorned, practices the Dharma — tamed,
calm, rightly restrained, and living in purity —
who harms no being with punishment:
that one is a brahmin, that one is a contemplative, that one is a monk.

Not by going naked, not by matted locks, not by mud,
not by fasting, not by sleeping on bare ground,
not by dust and grime, not by sitting in a squat with effort —
are people purified, nor do they pass beyond doubt.

Whether one be called a contemplative or a brahmin,
whoever clings to those very things,
without having attained the exhaustion of defilements,
falls away in the middle and utterly deteriorates.

Whether one be called a contemplative or a brahmin,
whoever clings to those very things,
without having attained the exhaustion of feelings,
falls away in the middle and utterly deteriorates.

Whether one be called a contemplative or a brahmin,
whoever clings to those very things
and holds entirely to a childish view,
falls away in the middle and utterly deteriorates.

Whether one be called a contemplative or a brahmin,
whoever clings to those very things —
childish persons of inferior understanding —
falls away in the middle and utterly deteriorates.

Whether one be called a contemplative or a brahmin,
whoever clings to those very things,
without having attained the supreme station,
falls away in the middle and utterly deteriorates.

O person of inferior understanding, what use are your matted locks?
What use is the antelope hide you wear?
Within, you are dense with confusion,
yet outside you groom yourself with care.

O person of inferior understanding, what use are your matted locks?
What use is the antelope hide you wear?
Within, you are full of defilement,
yet outside you groom yourself with care.

Not by birth does one become a brahmin,
not by matted locks, not by lineage.
Whoever possesses the Dharma of truth
and is pure — that one is a brahmin.

Not by birth does one become a brahmin —
not by matted locks, not by lineage.
Whoever abandons evil deeds both great and small —
because they have abandoned evil,
they are rightly called a brahmin.

Not by shaving the head alone does one become a renunciant.
Not by uttering "Om" does one become a brahmin.
Whoever possesses the Dharma of virtue
and is pure — that one is a brahmin.

Not by shaving the head alone does one become a renunciant.
Not by uttering "Om" does one become a brahmin.
Whoever abandons evil deeds both great and small —
because they have abandoned evil,
that one is both renunciant and brahmin.

Most people who bathe here
are not purified by water.
Whoever abandons evil deeds both great and small —
because they have abandoned evil,
that one is both renunciant and brahmin.

Whoever has utterly abandoned evil Dharmas,
is ever mindful in conduct,
and is a buddha in whom all bonds are exhausted —
that one, in all the worlds, is a brahmin.

The brahmin who has abandoned evil Dharmas,
who dwells without pretense and without turbidity,
who has fulfilled the Vedas and lived the holy life,
who speaks in season — that one speaks of Brahmā.

Whoever abides not in deception and is free of pride,
whoever is free of attachment, free of self, free of hope,
who has conquered strife and whose self has gone toward nirvāṇa —
that one is brahmin, that one is renunciant, that one is monk.

Whoever is born from a mother's womb,
if they still have clinging,
they are shown by name to be merely a child.
I do not call them a brahmin.
One who has no grasping whatsoever and no taking up —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever does no wrong in body, in speech,
or in mind,
whoever is well restrained in these three places —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever's words are not harsh,
who speaks in a way that gives understanding and is pleasant,
and who does not give rise to afflictions —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever endures with patience
those who kill, bind, and revile them,
and those who hate them,
who possesses the power and discipline of patience —

that one I call a brahmin.

One who is without anger, who holds to moral discipline,
who has discipline and is free of anxiety,
who is tamed and abides at the body's end —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever is unlike both the renunciant and the householder,
and equally unlike either,
who has few desires and has not gone forth from a home —
that one I call a brahmin.

One who has no longing for what is yet to come,
no grief for what is past,
who has won the battle free of contact's bonds —
that one I call a brahmin.

One who has no longing for what is yet to come,
no grief for what is past, free of dust,
calm and free of sorrow —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has few desires and does not tend others,
is tamed and steadfastly dwells in the essential,
whose defilements are exhausted and faults removed —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever is free of the hither shore and the farther shore,
and free of both hither and farther shore,
who has reached the end of all phenomena —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever is free of the hither shore and the farther shore,
and free of both hither and farther shore,
who is unattached to the three places —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever does not take up from the world anything at all,
whether short or long, fine or coarse, virtuous or non-virtuous —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has fully understood this very life,
whose own suffering is exhausted,

who is free of attachment and devoid of it —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever is not stained by either virtue or evil,
who is unstained, free of dust, and at peace —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has thoroughly transcended
whatever attachment there is in actions virtuous and evil,
who has transcended attachment and is fully liberated —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever exists neither before, nor after, nor in between,
who is free of dust and released from bondage —
that one I call a brahmin.

Like water on a lotus petal,
like a mustard seed on the tip of a needle —
whoever does not cling to evil:
that one I call a brahmin.

Like water on a lotus petal,
like a mustard seed on the tip of a needle —
whoever does not cling to desire:
that one I call a brahmin.

Like water on a lotus petal,
like a mustard seed on the tip of a needle —
whoever has utterly abandoned delight in existence:
that one I call a brahmin.

Like the moon, pure and stainless,
flawless and perfectly clear —
whoever is not stained by evil:
that one I call a brahmin.

Like the moon, pure and stainless,
flawless and perfectly clear —
whoever is not stained by desire:
that one I call a brahmin.

Like the moon, pure and stainless,
flawless and perfectly clear —

whoever has utterly abandoned delight in existence:
that one I call a brahmin.

As the sky is unaffected by mud and mire,
as the moon is unaffected by dust —
whoever is not stained by evil:
that one I call a brahmin.

As the sky is unaffected by mud and mire,
as the moon is unaffected by dust —
whoever is not stained by desire:
that one I call a brahmin.

As the sky is unaffected by mud and mire,
as the moon is unaffected by dust —
whoever has utterly abandoned delight in existence:
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever, while remaining here, is free of dust,
has reflected and accomplished the exhaustion of all defilements,
is tamed and dwells at the body's final end —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever is profound in wisdom and sound in mind,
skilled in what is the path and what is not the path,
and who attains the highest aim —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever lives among all kinds of people
sustained by begging alone,
harms no one whatsoever,
is steadfast and lives in purity,
knows all, and teaches the Dharma for the sake of practice —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has well abandoned desire,
has gone forth into homelessness,
and whose defilement of desire is completely exhausted —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever, among beings moving and stationary,
cuts no one down with the knife of killing,

does not kill and does not cause others to kill —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever makes peace with the discordant,
accepts the cutting blow of reproach with equanimity,
and is loving and beneficial toward all beings —
that one I call a brahmin.

Like a mustard seed on the tip of a needle —
whoever vanquishes attachment, aversion,
and the concealment of pride —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has thoroughly crossed over
the fortress of craving and the river of cyclic existence,
who thinks of journeying to the far shore after crossing,
who is not carried away by the mind itself,
and who has turned away from clinging —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever, in this world and in the world beyond,
is free of craving,
and whose craving for existence is completely exhausted —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever, in this world and in the world beyond,
is without attachment and longing,
who is free of attachment and thoroughly liberated —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has abandoned both pleasure and displeasure,
has become cool and is without defilement,
and stands firm having overcome the entire world —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has abandoned the bonds of human beings,
has thoroughly transcended the bonds of the gods,
and is completely freed from all bonds —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever is unknown to gods, gandharvas (celestial musicians),
and the realm of humans,

and unknown to the destiny of peace —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has nothing among phenomena
that remains unknown or unseen,
and who beholds what is to be known without limit —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever recalls their former abodes,
sees the higher realms and the lower states,
and having thereby attained the exhaustion of rebirth —
the sage who strives with direct knowledge,
who has fully understood suffering to its very end —
that one I call a brahmin.

that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever knows the liberation of mind,
whoever is freed from all attachment,
and who possesses the three knowledges —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has fully understood the death and rebirth
of all sentient beings,
that unobstructed, clear-seeing buddha —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has gone beyond all bonds,
is entirely without burning anguish,
is free of elation, and remains mindful — that Teacher —
that one I call a brahmin.

The Sage, victorious, the great sage,
the finest bull, the chief of the herd, the great elephant,
the immaculate, the one bathed, the buddha —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever surpasses all of saṃsāra,
crosses the river and leads others across,
the liberated one who has gone to the far shore —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever does not think upon wickedness,
neither cultivates it nor speaks of it,
but, remaining in stillness, contemplates free of dust —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever carries the patched robe,
who knows conscience and does not look toward desire,
and abides at the foot of a tree —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever, in order to abandon all suffering,
cultivates the peaceful noble eightfold path
with uprightness —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has no smallest abiding place,
in whom perception and mind are without the thorn of affliction,
and who has attained the rank of the deathless —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever dwells in a cave without a body,
wanders alone and travels far,
and tames the mind so difficult to tame —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever, upon the formless, the invisible, the boundless,
upon the utterly invisible, the subtle, the openly realized ground —
the ever-mindful one who dissolves all bonds, who is awakened —
that one, in this world, is a brahmin.

Whoever has cut through the life-force cord and the eye-cord,
has severed the rope and cast it far away,
and, abandoning all burning anguish, is a buddha —
that one I call a brahmin.

Whoever has cut through the cord of the eye, the rope of wickedness
bound for gain,
and, uprooting craving together with its root, has drawn it out entirely —
that one I call a brahmin.

By diligence cutting the stream of the river,
thoroughly crushing all desires,
and knowing the exhaustion of formations —

whoever is free of evil, that one is a brahmin.

Whoever has slain mother and father
and two kings who purify,
and has destroyed the realm together with its retinue —
whoever is free of evil, that one is a brahmin.

Whoever has slain mother and father
and two kings who are pure,
and has slain a fierce tiger —
whoever is free of evil, that one is a brahmin.

The fool who strikes a brahmin
and drives him away acts wickedly:
one must not strike brahmins,
one must not expel brahmins.

Whoever truly knows phenomena,
whether old or young —
to such a one honor and homage are due:
the pure brahmin is like a fire.

Whoever truly knows phenomena,
whether old or young —
to such a one honor and reverence are due:
the pure brahmin is like a fire.

Whoever truly knows the phenomena
taught by the fully awakened buddha —
to such a one honor and homage are due:
the pure brahmin is like a fire.

Whoever truly knows the phenomena
taught by the fully awakened buddha —
to such a one honor and reverence are due:
the pure brahmin is like a fire.

When a brahmin has gone to the far shore
of all phenomena,
then that one far surpasses
even a single flesh-eater.

When a brahmin has gone to the far shore
of all phenomena,
then all the sights and feelings perceived by that one
become subject to cessation.

When a brahmin has gone to the far shore
of all phenomena,
then through what that one has seen,
all conditions come to cessation.

When a brahmin has gone to the far shore
of all phenomena,
then through what that one has seen —
all conditionings come to cessation.

When a brahmin has gone to the far shore
of all phenomena,
then that one utterly transcends
birth, old age, and death.

As the sun illuminates by day,
as the moon gives light by night,
so a warrior adorned in armor shines bright,
and a brahmin who is wise shines bright.
As the sun illuminates by day,
as the moon gives light by night,
so the buddha, ever glorious,
shines bright both by day and by night.

Just as the mind turns away from what is foul,
in that same way there is not even a trace of that
in brahmins.

To whatever degree the mind turns away,
to that very degree conventional truth is exhausted.

When a brahmin strives and reflects,
and fully knows all phenomena along with their causes,
that one goes forth from these very phenomena,
and at that time all doubt is completely abandoned.

When a brahmin strives and reflects,
and fully knows suffering along with its causes,

that one goes forth from these very phenomena,
and at that time all doubt is completely abandoned.

When a brahmin strives and reflects,
and will attain the exhaustion of feeling,
that one goes forth from these very phenomena,
and at that time all doubt is completely abandoned.

When a brahmin strives and applies effort,
and will attain the exhaustion of conditions,
that one goes forth from these very phenomena,
and at that time all doubt is completely abandoned.

When a brahmin strives and reflects,
and will attain the exhaustion of defilements,
that one goes forth from these very phenomena,
and at that time all doubt is completely abandoned.

When a brahmin strives and reflects —
just as the sun, rising in the sky,
comes to illuminate the entire world —
that one goes forth from these very phenomena.

When a brahmin strives and reflects,
and, with understanding fully freed from all conditionings,
abides having dispelled the host of māras,
that one goes forth from these very phenomena.

This is the thirty-third chapter, the Chapter on Brahmins.

Summary verse: Tathāgata, hearer, self, comparing, and friend — these are the fifth. Nirvāṇa, seeing, wrongdoing, affliction, happiness, mind, monks' chapters — and the Chapter on Brahmins is the last.

The Udānavarga (Skt. udānavarga), gathered by the arhat Dharmatrāta, is complete.

Translated by the Indian master Vidyāprabhākara and the translator monk Rinchen Chok. Revised and established by the great-editor translator monk Paltsek.

Translator's Notes

- The line "what reason is there to rejoice" reflects a rhetorical question directed at those who take pleasure in worldly existence despite life's brevity.

- The phrase rendered "like fish that have fallen into the net of the fisherman" translates ལྷ་མོག་སེལ་བའི་ཕང་པོ་དང་།, which literally reads "like fish that have entered into the red of life" or "fallen into the living trap." The image is of fish caught in a weir or trap, a standard simile for beings ensnared in saṃsāra; the rendering reflects the doctrinal intent rather than a strictly literal gloss.

- The phrase rendered "craving's woman" translates the Tibetan literally, treating craving as a female figure personified, which is consistent with the Dhammapada tradition where *taṇhā* appears as a feminine noun and is occasionally anthropomorphized. Some translators render this more freely as "this craving, the woman," understanding it as an appositive rather than a genitive.

The final verse of the craving chapter and the opening of the heedfulness chapter correspond closely to Dhammapada verses 21 and following, and the imagery throughout is consistent with that canonical context.

- The closing line of the passage breaks off mid-stanza in the source text; the translation faithfully preserves that incompleteness.

- The verse "Through appearing as what is good when it is not good" renders a triplet

describing how heedless people are deceived by appearances — the not-good appears good, the not-dear appears dear, suffering appears as happiness. The Tibetan is compressed; the translation expands slightly for clarity in the spoken register.

The phrase rendered "the food of Māra that is so hard to abandon" translates a compound meaning literally "Māra's food, difficult to abandon"; in Buddhist doctrinal context this refers to sensory attachment, which sustains Māra's dominion over beings.

The three periods in "whichever of the three periods" refers to the three watches of the day or night — morning, midday, and evening — a standard division for practice in Vinaya and ethical literature.

- The passage is drawn from a Tibetan verse collection that closely parallels the Pāli Dhammapada and related Āgama material. The verse "life is dear to all / all tremble before being cut off" directly echoes Dhammapada 129–130 (Skt. Udānavarga 5.18–19), and the chapter colophon confirms this is the fifth chapter on what is dear (the chapter on "Priya" or the beloved). The final lines about the monk and moral discipline appear to be the opening of the following chapter and are left untranslated only at the point where the Tibetan text itself breaks off mid-sentence, which is reflected in the translation ending at the line break.
- The final verse is incomplete in the source text, breaking off mid-sentence. The translation reproduces this as it stands. The chapter ending markers for chapters six and seven are embedded in the verse flow as chapter colophons and are rendered accordingly in plain prose without formatting symbols.
- The phrase rendered as "forty-one thousand bubbles" reflects a compound enumerating the number of hell-realms described in terms of burst water-bubbles: one hundred thousand plus forty times one thousand plus one in a single figure — a traditional cosmological enumeration whose exact referent may belong to a specific Abhidharma or sūtra list not immediately identifiable here without the broader context.

The transition "This is the eighth canto: The Collection on Speech" marks a chapter colophon embedded in the text, signaling that the following verse begins a new chapter.

The final verse is syntactically incomplete as given, ending mid-sentence; the translation follows the Tibetan to the same point and leaves the clause open, as the continuation belongs to the next passage.

- The phrase rendered "uncertain about the form of the Sage" translates a compressed line that may mean "one should not be indifferent or wavering toward the form body of the Muni," possibly referring to veneration of the Buddha's image or person. The exact import is somewhat ambiguous in context; the rendering chosen preserves the most plausible doctrinal sense without over-specifying.

The verse "through vigilance one is delivered from the ocean, and through faith from rivers" reverses what might be expected; this is the reading the Tibetan supports, and the sequence likely reflects distinct metaphors for different spiritual challenges rather than a single extended comparison.

- The opening summary verse ("impermanence, desire, craving, heedfulness...these are the ten") recapitulates the ten topics of the preceding chapter on faith; this is a colophon-style summary verse typical of this genre.

The phrase rendered "the one with eyes" in the comparative series refers to the Buddha as the one possessing the eye of wisdom, a common epithet in Pāli and Tibetan canonical literature.

The repeated refrain on the four characteristics of formations — impermanence, suffering, emptiness, selflessness — corresponds closely to material found in Pāli Dhammapada and

- The phrase rendered "the three wholesome conceptual states" and "the three unwholesome ones" corresponds to wholesome and unwholesome types of thought or intention, likely referring to thoughts of renunciation, non-ill-will, and non-cruelty versus their opposites. The text is gnomic and the exact referent is not spelled out here; this is a standard doctrinal triad and does not require emendation.

The line rendered "even his head will surely deteriorate" reflects a somewhat cryptic Tibetan idiom; it may refer to the deterioration of his moral standing or his mental capacities, not merely a physical decline. The translation follows the literal sense.

The phrase rendered "make a powerless mind" reflects the literal Tibetan "ཡོན་ཏན་གྱིས་བརྒྱུད་པའི་མིང་།" — a mind that does not exert force, i.e., that yields rather than contends. The meaning is: why do they not cultivate a yielding, non-combatative mind? This idiomatic rendering is intentionally close to the original.

The "four meditative absorptions" for "bsam gtan bzhi" would standardly be the four dhyānas; however, the Tibetan reads "ting 'dzin bzhi" (four samādhis), which may refer to the four dhyānas or to the four foundations of mindfulness depending on the source text. The rendering as "four meditative absorptions" follows the most natural reading of ting 'dzin bzhi in this context.

- The phrase rendered "nothingness" for གཞི་མེད་པ་ corresponds to the formless absorption of nothingness (Skt. ākimcanya), and in context this verse likely refers to that meditative attainment rather than a philosophical category of non-existence, though the Tibetan phrase is a general expression meaning "there is nothing at all."

- The passage is from the Dhammapada or a related anthology in Tibetan translation, specifically drawing on the water-chapter and forest-chapter verses. The term "floods" renders

the Indic āsrava or ogha — outflows or floods of existence. The sixteenth and seventeenth sub-group markers are chapter or vagga divisions.

The line "like a brahmin on dry ground" echoes the Dhammapada image of the Tathāgata as one who has crossed the stream; "brahmin" here carries the extended Buddhist meaning of one who has expelled all evil, not merely a birth-caste designation.

The closing verse is cut off in the source text at "just as a lovely flower."

- The phrase rendered "the far shore that is not the far shore" reflects the Tibetan རྒྱལ་གླིང་མཐོན་པོ་འདྲེན་པ།, a paradoxical formulation meaning one who has reached the beyond that lies beyond ordinary conceptions of a "far shore" — pointing to nirvāṇa as transcending all conventional destinations. This corresponds to a known Dhammapada-related verse tradition.

The phrase "having understood this body to be like a bee" is unusual; the Tibetan reads རྒྱུ་ལྟར་འཛིན་པར་ཤིག་ལྟར་ which normally means "like a bee." In context and in parallel with the subsequent verse using རྒྱུ་ལྟར་འཛིན་པར་ཤིག་ལྟར་ ("like a bubble"), it is likely that in the first pair of verses the body and worlds are compared to a bee as something that collects and moves on — though some witnesses may intend a different comparison. The bubble simile in the second pair is unambiguous.

- The phrase rendered "king of the tamed" in the horse-riding stanza is a superlative idiom meaning the finest or greatest among tamed creatures, used here as an image for the excellently disciplined mind. The text breaks off mid-verse at the final line, which ends the passage as given.

The repeated refrain "that ground they can never reach" renders a Tibetan construction meaning the attainment of a particular spiritual ground or state is inaccessible to those who rely on external vehicles rather than self-taming. The term "ground" here carries the sense of an achieved spiritual stage rather than physical ground.

"Horses of Sindhu" refers to the prized thoroughbred horses of the Indus region, famed in Indian literature for their speed and nobility.

- The summary verse is a mnemonic (chapter-index verse) recapitulating the ten chapter topics of what appears to be a larger collection, here closing the anger chapter as the tenth. The terms rendered are quite compressed; the list "the path of renunciation, veneration, craving, the fifth — mindfulness, droplets of water, flowers, horses, and anger" corresponds to ten chapter headings, not to a single doctrinal sequence, and the counting is approximate in the Tibetan.

The phrase rendered "the pride of victory" for "विजयमहिम्ना" in context with "सर्वभूतानां भवतां प्रियं वदामि" is genuinely difficult: the first विजयमहिम्ना may be the buddha's legitimate self-confidence or "pride" in having overcome evil, while the second instance involves a related locution. The passage reflects a bold first-person proclamation of the Buddha's unparalleled status, paralleled in Pāli sources (the "lion's roar" at birth), so both instances are rendered in that spirit.

- The final verse fragment ending with "imbued with the attachment of desire" is incomplete in the passage as given; it runs into the next section and the translation preserves it as such without fabricating a conclusion.

The phrase rendered "mansion born of Dharma" translates a compound meaning a palace or splendid dwelling that has arisen from the Dharma — a classical image for the elevated vantage of awakening from which buddhas survey beings. Some editions read this slightly differently, but the sense is consistent across commentaries.

The simile of "ogresses" renders the Tibetan for *srin mo*, female demonic beings (*rakṣasīs*) who waylay merchants — a classical Indian literary topos also found in the Pāli canon.

- The phrase rendered "those who live on fragrance" refers to *gandharvas*, celestial musicians who subsist on scent rather than solid food; the Tibetan "dri zas" is a calque of the Sanskrit *gandharva* meaning literally "fragrance-eaters."

The lines "For the sake of one's own good, one should relinquish the good of many others" are doctrinally striking and likely reflect a polemical or rhetorical inversion meant to emphasize self-discipline as the foundation for benefiting others; some commentators read this differently. The passage as a whole is consistent with the Dhammapada tradition.

The chapter colophon "twenty-second chapter, on the topic of hearing" marks the boundary between two distinct sections in the Tibetan anthology being translated.

- The series of "attainments" rendered variously as unshakeable, hard to behold, lofty, supreme, deathless, nectar-like, dustless, and stainless are technical epithets for *nirvāṇa*. The Tibetan terms follow the Dhammapada's standard Pali equivalents closely, and the translation preserves the cumulative rhetorical structure. The final verse on the Three Jewels appears to be mid-sentence at the passage's end, as the source text breaks off.
- The term rendered "elemental spirits" translates རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, which can refer to spirits associated with the elements or to beings more generally. In some Pāli-parallel contexts this corresponds to *bhūta*, elemental or spirit-beings. The rendering "elemental spirits" captures the doctrinal sense adequately.

The term རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ marks this as the chapter on comparison or contrast, and the numeral confirms it as chapter twenty-four. The following heading, རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, marks the beginning of the *Udānavarga*-style chapter of intentional or purposeful sayings, corresponding to the *Udānavarga*'s chapter on association. རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ indicates this is the third canonical section-division.

- The phrase rendered "the fully awakened buddha" translates *rdzogs sangs rgyas*, literally "complete buddha" or "perfectly awakened one," corresponding to Sanskrit *samyaksaṃbuddha*. The distinction from a *pratyekabuddha* or *arhat* is deliberate and doctrinal.

The image of the bronze vessel and clapper (*lkhar ba'i snod la brdungs pa*) is a traditional simile: striking a bell or gong produces prolonged resonance just as retaliation prolongs conflict and rebirth; leaving it unstruck ends the ringing, just as non-retaliation ends the cycle. The rendering "bronze vessel with a clapper" captures this.

The final *gāthās* from "Freedom from illness" onward are closely parallel to Dhammapada verses 203–208, confirming the passage's canonical affiliation.

- The verse beginning "Hard to behold, boundless, not seen there" is condensed and elliptical in the Tibetan, resisting fully transparent rendering. The lines appear to describe the nature of *nirvāṇa* as inconceivable and beyond ordinary perception, leading into the description of one who has realized truth and abandoned craving. The translation follows the most grammatically defensible reading, but this stanza is genuinely difficult and its precise syntax is uncertain.

The verse beginning "Tormented by this, burned and deeply burned" is a single-line stanza followed immediately by the refrain. The antecedent of "this" is unclear in isolation; it most likely refers to the fire of craving discussed in the surrounding context, as the metaphor of burning is standard for craving in Pāli and Sanskrit parallels.

The final verse is incomplete in the source text as given, breaking off after "subject to aging, death, and delusion."

- The phrase rendered "conduct going astray increases to the left" translates a Tibetan idiom

for deterioration or wrongdoing; "to the left" carries the sense of the inauspicious or deviant direction.

The image of "splitting open the hollow of the egg" is a classical Indian metaphor for the bodhisattva or liberated being breaking free from the shell of conditioned existence, found in several canonical contexts.

The chapter colophon "twenty-sixth chapter of the Nirvāṇa section" marks a structural division of the source text, likely the Udāna or a related Pāli-derived anthology in Tibetan translation.

- The phrase rendered "multiplied the charnel ground" reflects a metaphorical usage in which "charnel ground" stands for cyclic existence or the domain of death and rebirth; the Tibetan *dur khrod* (Sanskrit *śmaśāna*) is literal but functions here as an image for the realm of suffering and death that the two extremes perpetuate. This reading follows the context of the surrounding passage.

The verse rendering "the chariot of a king displayed in splendor" translates *rgyal po'i shing rta bkra ba ltar*, where *bkra ba* suggests something bright, ornate, or resplendent on display. The chariot image functions as a standard simile for the body as something impressive in appearance but ultimately a constructed and perishable vehicle.

The line rendered "there will be no more becoming" translates *yang srid med par*, meaning no further existence or rebirth in *saṃsāra* — a standard expression for liberation.

- The opening stanzas of this passage, concerning "seeing" and "the similar," present genuine interpretive difficulty. The Tibetan plays on the term "dra" meaning "similar" or "likeness" or "image" and the repeated word "seeing." This appears to be a philosophical verse about the relationship between perception and the appearance of selfhood: the notion that ordinary seeing — which perceives similars and images — is distinct from direct insight, and that failure to see suffering generates the view of a self. The verse is metrically irregular and possibly excerpted from a longer didactic poem. The rendering given is the most philosophically coherent reading, though the chain of argument is compressed and some transitions remain opaque.

The phrase rendered as "spirits" in "the wise, with spirits, or with common folk" translates a term that can mean ghosts, local deities, or non-human beings, and the context is social mixing of different kinds of companions.

- The tenfold list of misfortunes in this passage follows a standard enumeration found in Pāli and Sanskrit parallel sources. The Tibetan presents them as a somewhat compressed list; the translation renders each item as a separate line to preserve the enumerative logic while keeping the verse form clear.

The final verse shifts to first person, likely the voice of a practitioner or the text's narrative persona declaring their own fearlessness at death on the basis of a life of merit — a standard rhetorical device in didactic verse of this genre.

- The final sentence breaks off mid-verse in the source, reproducing what appears to be an incomplete passage at the end of the input. The translation renders what is present and stops where the Tibetan stops. The next verse is a well-known one about the arhat who has slain father, mother, and two kings, but it was not included in the passage given and so has not been translated.

The line "like a mismatched goat's jaw" renders the idiom of something ill-fitting or incongruous, a standard image in this corpus for incompatibility between inner vice and outward appearance.

The phrase rendered "entering again and again into the womb of blame" carries both the literal sense of rebirth in inferior wombs and the figurative sense of perpetual censure; both meanings are active here.

- The opening couplet about "two pure kings" is obscure. The phrase "二王純淨" most naturally reads "two pure kings," and in context this appears to be the concluding half-verse of the preceding stanza about killing father and mother — continuing the Dhammapada-style list of those who have killed the two kings (father and mother), subdued the realm, and so on, resulting in purification. The translation renders the literal sense; commentarial tradition would explain "father" as attachment and "mother" as craving, "two kings" as the views of eternalism and nihilism, and so forth.

The phrase "□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□" rendered as "no support at the far shore of the father" is unusual. It may mean "having gone to the far shore of the father" in the sense of having transcended it, or "having no refuge in the farthest shore of fatherhood." The exact doctrinal referent is uncertain; this appears to be a variant stanza-form of the preceding group, substituting a different first-line predicate.

The final line breaks off mid-sentence, consistent with the source material being a continuous extract.

- The phrase rendered "path, where there is nothing to travel" translates a compound involving "no going" and "step" or "pace," pointing to the buddha's boundless domain that transcends ordinary movement or traversal. The fourfold repetition of this verse with the variants "domain" and "power" is present in the Tibetan and is preserved in the translation.

The closing half-verse is clearly a continuation into the next passage and breaks off mid-sentence in the source; the translation reflects this.

- The phrase rendered "to honor one's mother" and "to honor one's father" translates ආරාධනාමාත්රා and ආරාධනාමාත්රා, literally "to hold or support the father" and "to hold or support the mother." This is the standard Pāli dhamma parallel (*mātāpitu-upatthāna*) and is rendered accordingly.

The line 有智有慧有捨心 is syntactically compressed. The reading adopted is "with a noble and wisdom-endowed mind of relinquishment," taking 有智有慧 as "endowed with letting go or giving up," a quality of the aspirant who strives to exhaust suffering. This is consistent with the doctrinal context but the grammar admits some latitude.

- The passage contains what appears to be a deliberate or scribal repetition of two stanzas (the "heard much Dharma" verses with "body" and then "mind," followed again by a near-identical pair). This repetition is preserved faithfully as it appears in the Tibetan, though it may reflect a textual anomaly or a scribal dittography in the source.

The final verse ends mid-sentence, indicating the passage breaks off at this point; the translation preserves that open ending accordingly.

The reference to Mithilā and the fire recalls the story of King Janaka of Mithilā, a well-known figure in Indian tradition used as an illustration of non-attachment — one whose city could burn without his losing anything, since he identified with nothing as his own.

- This passage is drawn from the Tibetan translation of the Dhammapada and related Udānavarga material. The "chapter of deliberate utterances" corresponds to the Udānavarga's Cittavarga and related chapters. The "builder of the house" verses are among the most celebrated in the entire Pali and Sanskrit Dharmapada traditions, spoken by the newly awakened Buddha reflecting on the dissolution of craving's grip. The phrase rendered "the mind, separated from formations, finds its exhaustion right here" is doctrinally dense: the mind's severance from conditioning factors and attainment of nirvāṇa is indicated. The term rendered "bodyless cave" refers to the heart or chest cavity as the traditional locus of mind in

Indian medical and contemplative thought.

- The thirty-six wrong views mentioned in the verse on conceptual elaboration refer to a classical enumeration in which wrong views arise from craving and conceptual proliferation regarding the three times (past, present, future) and the three realms, sometimes enumerated differently across sources. This is a standard canonical reference and not an interpretive invention.

The verse sequence beginning "Mind goes before all things" corresponds closely to the opening verses of the Pāli Dhammapada (verses 1 and 2), here in Tibetan translation. The rendering follows the doctrinal sense of the lineage: mind as the forerunner and chief of all actions.

The phrase rendered "seven limbs of awakening" refers to the seven factors of awakening (Sanskrit bodhyaṅga): mindfulness, investigation of phenomena, diligence, joy, pliancy, meditative absorption, and equanimity.

- The phrase rendered "the five-branched lute" refers to a classical Indian stringed instrument with five sections or registers. The comparison is that single-pointed meditative clarity surpasses even the finest sensory pleasure of music. Some editions show slight variation between the two parallel stanzas on meditative absorption; the second repeats with the vocative "O Sage" addressed to the reader or the practitioner in an exclamatory tone, which is preserved here as a rhetorical device.

The closing colophon "the thirty-first chapter of the mind" indicates this is a chapter-end marker in a larger anthology, likely a Tibetan transmission of a Buddhist anthology text in the Udānavarga or related genre.

- The phrase rendered as "the field of practice" for རྒྱལ་ཁོ་ལོ་ is somewhat compressed; the verse is contrasting a monk who earns no livelihood by craft or trade yet finds joy in the monastic domain. The term རྒྱལ་ཁོ་ལོ་ here most naturally carries this sense of the "field" or sphere of practice and community rather than a literal agricultural field, though some ambiguity remains.

The final verse is incomplete in the source text as given, ending mid-sentence; the translation reflects this.

The stanza on abandoning virtue and evil reflects a standard formulation found in Pāli parallels where "the monk" is defined not merely by begging but by having transcended both wholesome and unwholesome karma — a point the commentarial tradition stresses.

- The phrase rendered "cuts the warmth of effort" translates a Tibetan idiom for abandoning the heat or momentum of one's striving, sometimes interpreted as losing the intensity necessary for liberation. The verse structure here signals a monk who has attained some degree of concentration but then slackens, and the phrase marks that slackening as the reason such a one does not qualify as a true monk.

The passage "what there is to delight in is suffering, and what there is to be weary of is bliss" renders a deliberate inversion: the text paradoxically identifies what worldly beings enjoy as suffering and what they find unpleasant or wearying as genuine bliss, pointing toward the transcendence of ordinary valuation.

The closing verses follow the same refrain structure as the preceding passage, with each new stanza adding a further quality of the liberated monk while the final verse is left incomplete, continuing into the next passage.

- The phrase rendered "the far shore of the not-far-shore" translates a deliberate paradox in the Tibetan: འགྲོ་ལོ་འགྲོ་ལོ་འགྲོ་ལོ་འགྲོ་ལོ་, literally "one who has gone to the other shore of what is not the other shore." This corresponds to a well-attested Pāli and Sanskrit formulation in which the monk is said to have crossed beyond what ordinary people take to be the farther

shore, arriving at a shore that transcends the conventional distinction between near and far. The paradoxical phrasing is intentional and is preserved in the translation.

The image of "the thorns of the village" is a standard idiom for the entanglements and provocations of lay social life, including conflicts, gossip, and the objects of sensory temptation encountered in towns and settlements. It is kept literal in keeping with the poetic register.

- The phrase rendered "the thorn of doubt" translates a compound that can mean doubt or ambivalence in the sense of mental conflict and indecision; the image of a thorn piercing the mind is standard in this verse tradition.

The phrase "latent tendencies" renders a term literally meaning "what lies in wait" or "what lies dormant," a close equivalent to the technical sense of latent karmic propensities.

The stanza beginning "A monk who possesses discipline" breaks the established refrain pattern and shifts to a compressed, aphoristic style; this appears to be a transitional verse closing the chapter section, and is rendered accordingly.

The phrase "antelope hide" for the outer garment worn by ascetics is the standard identification in the commentarial tradition for the term here translated.

- The phrase rendered "who has fulfilled the Vedas" translates a term meaning mastery of the Vedic learning tradition; the text uses it ironically to redirect the meaning of brahminhood entirely to ethical and spiritual qualities rather than ritual birth or scriptural recitation.

The line "who abides at the body's end" conveys the sense of one who lives simply, subsisting on whatever sustenance the body's extremity requires — a standard image of ascetic minimalism.

The verse on the "three places" left unspecified in the Tibetan likely refers to the three realms of existence (desire, form, and formless), though some commentaries understand it as past, present, and future.

- The stanza beginning "whoever is unknown to gods, gandharvas, and humans, and unknown to the destiny of peace" is slightly paradoxical: it likely means that this person's inner attainment is unrecognizable or untracked by beings of those realms, while also not being known through the ordinary conceptual category of "the peaceful destiny." Some commentators read the last line differently, as the person not knowing or not seeking the peaceful destiny, but the reading adopted here follows the more natural Tibetan syntax.

The stanza on the sage who recalls former lives, sees higher and lower states, and attains the exhaustion of birth is the culminating verse of the brahmin chapter. The Tibetan syntax places "the sage who strives with direct knowledge" as an appositive subject, with "who has fully understood suffering to its very end" as the concluding qualification, and the refrain "that one I call a brahmin" is implied at the close, consistent with the Pali Dhammapada chapter on the brahmin.

- The passage contains two famous allegorical verses about slaying "mother and father" and "two kings." In the commentarial tradition, "mother" and "father" are understood as craving and conceit (or alternatively craving and ignorance), not literal parents; "two kings" refers to the views of eternalism and annihilation; "the realm with its retinue" refers to the twelve sense bases; and the "fierce tiger" represents doubt. This is a standard doctrinal reading shared by Pāli and Sanskrit commentaries alike and should be understood accordingly.

The final verse is incomplete in the source text as supplied, cutting off mid-stanza. The translation renders precisely what is present.

The phrase rendered "life-force cord and eye-cord" renders a pair of technical metaphors for the vital force and visual consciousness bound in cyclic existence; the exact referents have some variation across commentaries.

- The colophon names three figures: the Indian paṇḍita Vidyāprabhākara, the translator Rinchen Chok (Rinchen Mchog), and the senior revision editor Paltsek (Dpal Brtseg), all well-attested translators of the early imperial period. The summary verse at the end is a mnemonic verse listing the chapter titles of the entire collection; it is a bibliographic device, not part of the doctrinal text. The phrase rendered "conventional truth is exhausted" follows the Tibetan literally; this is a striking formulation suggesting that as aversion to phenomena deepens, even the conventional framework of experience dissolves — a point worth flagging as potentially significant for the doctrinal interpretation of this verse.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.